SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

CHALLENGES AND ADAPTATION OF TEACHERS TEACHING NON-SPECIALIZED SUBJECTS

A Thesis Proposal Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Teacher Education

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF TECHNICAL VOCATIONAL TEACHER EDUCATION

By

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
JOHN PAUL C. CEREZ
RICA C. JAYME
PRINCE ROBERT T. MIOLE
JONATHAN C. RABUYA
JORDAN JAMES M. VASQUEZ

ADVISER: RYAN M. LAGBAS, LPT

MARCH 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

		Pages
TITLE PAGE		i
TABLE OF CONTENT		ii
LIST OF TABLES		iii
LIST OF FIGURES		iv
CHAPTER		
1	**THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE**	1
	1.1 Background of the study	1
	1.2 Review of Related Literature	5
	1.3 Theoretical Framework	32
	1.4 Schematic Diagram	35
	1.5 Statement of the Problem/Objectives of the Study	37
	1.6 Hypothesis	39
	1.7 Definition of Terms	42
2	**RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**	42
	2.1 Research Design	42
	2.2 Research Materials and Methods	42
	2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample	43
	2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan	49
	2.5 Research Ethical Standards	52
REFERENCES		
CURRICULUM VITAE		
APPENDICES		

A. Letter of Approval
B. Instrument and Informed Consent
C. Map of the Research Locale
D. Narrative & Photo Documentation

LIST OF TABLES

Table		Pages
1	Table of Respondents	44

LIST OF FIGURE

Figure No.	Title	Page
1	Schematic Diagram	35

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The teaching profession requires a deep sense of passion, love, and dedication. It is defined by its high level of complexity and dynamism and demands both subject-matter competence and pedagogical skills. It is universally accepted that teaching is among the noblest professions. Gaso (2025), Leonin (2024), and Obias et al., (2025), assert that the multifaceted nature of teaching makes it one of the most esteemed careers, as the initial step in preparing students for any profession is rooted in education. Moreover, teachers' flexibility and adaptability enable them to effectively perform these multifaceted roles. With this, teachers are often described as "jacks of all trades" individuals capable of carrying out diverse tasks and responsibilities with competence.

Teachers' ability to improve the quality and effectiveness of teaching depends on the integration of thoughtful planning, the integration of flexible teaching methods, and continuous reflection on their classroom experiences (Dursun et al., 2025). These abilities pave the way towards achieving Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4): Quality Education, which aims to ensure "inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all." UNESCO (2024) emphasizes that high-quality teacher education and continuous specialized training are fundamental in preparing teachers to deliver quality education that is holistic, transformative, inclusive, effective, and relevant. Ideally, teachers are assigned based on their specialized subjects, qualifications, and professional training. However, there are instances when they are required to teach beyond the area of their expertise. Such teachers are commonly referred to as teachers teaching non-specialized subjects (Buenacosa & Petallo, 2022).

Teaching non-specialized subjects is a prevalent issue worldwide, which significantly affects the overall quality of education (Fullido, 2025). This phenomenon can be linked to various causes; studies

found shortages of subject specialists, unequal subject load distribution, and policy gaps (Javines & Azarias,2024) as the primary causes. Rodriguez (2025) found that personal dedication and a desire to help others were among the most important factors affecting the prevalence of out-of-field education. Other reasons include a lack of teachers in specific subjects, insufficient qualified applicants, administrative decisions, and a lack of interest in the subject one is assigned (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021).

In the Philippines, the EDCOM 2 report released in January 2025 states that 62% of high school teachers teach subjects outside of their college major, highlighting a significant misalignment between teacher training programs and school-level needs. This report underscores the prevalence of teaching non-specialized subject phenomenon in the country, which poses major challenges that significantly affect both teachers' teaching confidence and effectiveness and students' learning outcomes.

Teachers teaching non-specialized subjects face a wide range of challenges that can make them question their teaching competence and affect their overall effectiveness. Studies indicate that these teachers often struggle with content mastery, requiring additional time to study and understand topics beyond their areas of specialization (Baras & Gillo, 2024; Roxas, 2022). Baras & Gillo (2024) and Bugwak (2021) reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects frequently experience low self-esteem and difficulty in maintaining classroom authority. Moreover, Roxas (2022) found that lesson planning and activity preparation are often time-consuming and stressful, as these teachers must exert additional effort to design appropriate materials and strategies for unfamiliar subjects. Choosing and applying effective teaching methods also pose a recurring challenge, as many teachers teaching non-specialized subjects are uncertain about the most suitable approaches to promote student understanding (Arendain & Limpot, 2022; Bugwak, 2021). In addition, Yumang (2021) highlighted that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects often struggle to respond confidently and accurately to students' inquiries.

On the other hand, studies have discovered that this phenomenon significantly influences students' academic performance. Students in classes handled by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects are more likely to experience surface learning, achieve lower test scores, occasionally lose self-confidence (Nakar & Du Plessis, 2023), and demonstrate lower academic performance compared to those taught by teachers within their areas of specialization (Branzuela et al., 2023).

Despite these challenges, several studies have also revealed that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects employ various adaptations to manage the demands of teaching subjects outside their expertise. Baras and Gillo (2024) emphasize that careful lesson planning is one of the most common adaptations, as teachers prepare lessons and materials ahead of time to enhance their understanding before entering the classroom. Collaboration through sharing, mentoring, and teamwork is also a key adaptive strategy (Baras & Gillo, 2024); Bugwak, 2021). Furthermore, Castro et al. (2023) highlighted that professional training plays a vital role in helping teachers build competence and confidence in teaching general courses.

Additionally, the United Nations Secretary-General's High-Level Panel on the Teaching Profession (2024) noted the growing global shortage of qualified teachers one of the major causes of teaching non-specialized subjects. In response, the UN has proposed a set of strategies and recommendations aimed at revitalizing the teaching profession, including equitable teacher deployment, strengthened teacher education programs, and continuous professional development to equip educators with specialized competencies aligned with their assigned subjects.

Given the continued prevalence of the teaching non-specialized subject phenomenon and its impact on the overall quality of education, it is imperative to examine the specific challenges that teachers encounter when assigned to teach subjects beyond their field of specialization, as well as the adaptation

they employ to address these challenges. Hence, this study aims to investigate the difficulties face by non-specialized teachers and to explore the adaptation to effectively manage their teaching responsibilities.

In addition, the study seeks to determine whether there are significant differences in the challenges and adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects when grouped according to their profile variables, namely sex, qualification, years of teaching, area of specialization, subjects handled out of specialization, and school location. It also aims to examine whether a significant relationship exists between the challenges encountered and the adaptation employed by the respondents.

To achieve these objectives, the study will employ a descriptive–comparative and correlational quantitative research design to provide comprehensive insights into the nature, extent, and interrelationships among the identified variables. Descriptive statistics will be used to summarize the teachers' demographic profiles and responses, while inferential statistics specifically the t-test and Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) will determine significant differences in the challenges and adaptation across teacher profiles. Moreover, the Pearson correlation coefficient will be utilized to examine the significant relationship between the challenges encountered and the adaptation employed.

This study is significant as it addresses the growing prevalence of teaching non-specialized subject and its impact on teacher competence, instructional quality, and student learning outcomes, offering valuable insights into one of the most critical challenges in today's education system. It provides teachers with a deeper understanding of the difficulties they encounter such as limited content mastery, increased preparation time, low confidence, and challenges in selecting appropriate teaching strategies while identifying effective adaptation like careful lesson planning, collaboration, peer mentoring, and participation in professional training. For school administrators and educational leaders, the study offers evidence-based information that can guide better teacher deployment practices, targeted support programs, and more strategic staffing, especially in light of the EDCOM 2 (2025) report that 62% of

Philippine high school teachers teach outside their specialization. Teacher Education Institutions may use the findings to strengthen and align their curricula with school demands by integrating interdisciplinary content and flexible pedagogical training, while policymakers may draw from the results to refine policies addressing teacher shortages, subject mismatches, and the need for continuous specialized training. Students indirectly benefit through improved instructional delivery and enhanced learning experiences, and future researchers gain a valuable reference for further studies on teachers teaching non-specialized subjects, teacher development, and instructional effectiveness. Anchored on UN High-Level Panel (2024), and literature on teachers teaching non-specialized subjects, this study ultimately contributes to broader national and global goals of ensuring inclusive, equitable, and high-quality education under Sustainable Development Goal 4.

1.2 REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

The information, study literature, and conceptual material that have already been published and are relevant to the subject at hand are reviewed in this chapter. It helps researchers better understand and provides the basic information they need to plan and carry out the study.

Teaching is quite laborious supports the multifaceted task of teaching as the noblest of all professions, as it lays the foundation for any discipline they desire (Leonin,2024). Teaching is widely recognized as one of the most vital and noble professions worldwide. Ideally, teachers are assigned based on their specialized subjects, qualifications, and professional training (Buenacosa & Petallo, 2022). There are instances when they are required to teach beyond the area of their expertise. Such teachers are commonly referred to as teachers teaching non-specialized subjects (Buenacosa & Petallo, 2022).

Teaching non-specialized subjects refers to the assignment of teachers to instruct in areas for which they lack the appropriate training, qualifications, or expertise. This may involve teaching subjects,

grade levels, or school types outside their certified specialization. According to, Hobbs and Whannell (2020) as cited by Perez, (2024) this practice involves deploying teachers to roles for which they do not possess the necessary qualifications or relevant knowledge in a particular subject or grade level. Similarly, Co et al. (2021), describe teachers of non-specialized subjects as those who are trained in one field but are required to teach in another.

Teaching non-specialized subject is a prevalent issue that affects teacher effectiveness, student learning, and overall school performance (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021). This phenomenon is particularly common in rural areas due to teacher shortages, recruitment challenges, and limited access to resources (Rodriguez, 2025).

Teachers who teach outside of their area face many challenges. Study of Rodriguez, (2025) emphasizes that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects encountered lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, and support and resources. The study of Ogundairo,(2024) highlights that these teachers also face psychological challenges. Moreover, Salvador et.al (2022), found that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects adapt to the challenges they encounter by relying on several key adaptations often focus on learning from seasoned teachers, learning from textbooks, learning from schemes of work, and training and seminars. Furthermore, Gomez & Petalla, (2025) highlighted that these teachers also using technology to navigate unfamiliar content and instructional demands, demonstrating that digital tools have become an essential component of their adaptation.

Challenges

Teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their specialization encounter multifaceted challenges that significantly impact their instructional effectiveness and professional well-being. Study of Rodriguez, (2025) emphasizes that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects encountered lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, and support and resources. The study of Ogundairo,(2024) highlights

that these teachers also face psychological challenges. The most prominent difficulties include insufficient content knowledge and mastery of unfamiliar subject matter (Espiritu and Espiritu, 2025) and Gaso (2025), which directly affects their ability to deliver quality instruction. These teachers struggle with fundamental pedagogical tasks such as lesson planning, designing appropriate assessments, and staying current with curriculum changes (Gaso, (2025); (Roxas, 2022). The lack of adequate professional development opportunities and institutional support compounds these challenges, leaving teachers without the necessary resources and training to effectively navigate unfamiliar content areas (Magtulis & Brunio, 2025; Ciata et al., 2024).

Additionally, teachers face difficulties in developing innovative instructional strategies and accessing appropriate teaching materials for subjects outside their expertise (Magtulis & Brunio, 2025; Tope, 2023). These challenges often result in increased stress, potential burnout, and reduced job satisfaction, ultimately affecting both teacher performance and student learning outcomes (Tope, 2023; Ciata et al., 2024). The problem is further exacerbated by administrative decisions and teacher shortages that necessitate such assignments, creating a systemic issue that requires targeted interventions including specialized training programs, mentorship, and strategic teacher placement based on subject specialization (Gaso, 2025; Candelario & Abo, 2025).

Lack of Subject Knowledge

Teachers assigned to teach non-specialized subjects face persistent challenges that significantly affect their instructional competence and overall teaching effectiveness. Rodriguez, (2025) highlighted that teachers handling subjects outside their area of specialization often struggle with content mastery, lesson preparation, and the clear explanation of concepts. This limited familiarity with the subject matter leads to reduced instructional confidence, constrained use of appropriate teaching strategies, and

difficulty in addressing learners' questions and misconceptions. As a result, instructional delivery tends to be less effective and less responsive to students' learning needs. A growing body of literature emphasizes that one of the most critical difficulties encountered by these teachers is the lack of subject or content knowledge, which undermines their confidence, instructional quality, and ability to facilitate meaningful learning experiences (Hobbs and Porsch, 2021; Rebucas, 2022; Rodriguez, 2025).

Content knowledge refers to a teacher's understanding of the subject matter or learning material to be taught (Maharani & Hongki, 2025). However, several studies consistently report that teaching beyond one's specialization results in inadequate subject mastery and weak conceptual understanding (Hobbs and Porsch, 2021; Rebucas, 2022; Rodriguez, 2025) . Scholars argue that insufficient subject knowledge lies at the core of the challenges associated with teaching non-specialized subjects (Buenacosa & Petalla, 2022; Gomez & Petalla, 2025; Luft et al., 2020).

The literature further indicates that teachers with limited subject knowledge are more likely to provide superficial instruction, which restricts students' opportunities for deep and meaningful learning Nakar & Du Plesis, (2023) noted that such limitations may reduce students' confidence and lead to surface-level understanding rather than conceptual depth. Similarly, Mizzi (2022) explained that teachers often experience difficulty transferring knowledge to new subject areas without a strong foundational understanding, negatively affecting their instructional decision-making, classroom engagement, and professional confidence.

Beyond content mastery, teachers assigned outside their specialization also encounter challenges in conceptual understanding and application. While some teachers may grasp basic concepts, they often struggle to explain abstract ideas clearly or apply concepts accurately to real-life situations and problem-solving tasks (Arendain & Limpot, 2022; Hobbs & Porsch, 2021). Tope (2023) emphasized that these

teachers frequently find it difficult to provide authentic, real-world examples and learning activities that promote the practical application of concepts, which is essential for deep learning.

Several studies corroborate these findings, showing that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects struggle with conceptual depth and lesson meaningfulness Osman and Villocino, (2024), Pacaña, (2019), and Rebucas, (2022). These difficulties are closely linked to challenges in concept application, as limited subject knowledge constrains teachers' ability to design higher-order learning tasks, address misconceptions, and facilitate inquiry-based learning.

Research across diverse educational contexts further reveals that teachers without formal academic preparation in the subjects they teach often demonstrate weak content mastery, limited conceptual accuracy, and shallow explanations, ultimately weakening instructional quality (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021); Badaru & Ndlovu, 2025). Insufficient subject knowledge also affects teachers' classroom practices, leading them to rely heavily on textbooks, scripted lessons, and rote teaching strategies, thereby limiting student-centered and inquiry-based approaches (Badaru & Ndlovu, 2025).

Moreover, awareness of limited subject expertise negatively influences teachers' professional identity and self-efficacy. Gaso, (2025) reported that teachers teaching outside their specialization often experience feelings of inadequacy and uncertainty, which further impact their instructional confidence and classroom engagement. Although some teachers attempt to address these gaps through self-study or collaboration with colleagues, such efforts are often insufficient to compensate for the absence of strong foundational subject knowledge (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021).

Overall, the reviewed literature underscores that inadequate content knowledge and limited concept application are persistent and systemic challenges among teachers assigned to non-specialized subjects. These issues significantly affect instructional effectiveness, learner engagement, and learning outcomes, highlighting the urgent need for targeted content-focused professional development and improved alignment between teachers' specialization and teaching assignments.

Classroom Management

Classroom management is a fundamental component of effective teaching, as it directly influences student engagement, learning behavior, and instructional flow. However, numerous empirical studies have consistently shown that teachers assigned to teach non-specialized subjects frequently experience difficulties in managing classroom dynamics effectively. According to the study of Rodriguez (2025) emphasized that teachers assigned to teach non-specialized subjects encounter significant challenges in classroom management. The study explained that limited subject familiarity often affects teachers' confidence and authority in managing classroom dynamics, making it difficult to maintain discipline and sustain students' attention. When teachers are unsure of the content, they tend to focus more on managing behavior rather than facilitating meaningful learning, which disrupts lesson flow and instructional pacing. This lack of confidence may also reduce teachers' ability to implement effective classroom routines, address disruptive behaviors promptly, and engage learners actively.

Consequently, students are more likely to lose interest and disengage during lessons, with Rodriguez (2025) reporting that 52.4% of teachers agreed that students tend to lose interest when taught by non-specialized teachers. Classroom management issues experienced by non-specialized teachers include student misbehavior, difficulty sustaining engagement, and the need for diversified pedagogical approaches and strong pedagogical skills (Klusmann et al., 2008), as cited by Du Plessis & McDonagh, 2021). These challenges are largely attributed to limited subject matter knowledge, which directly

influences teachers' pedagogical content knowledge and classroom practices (Bugwak, 2021; Du Plessis, 2019; Caneda & Biol, 2025).

Similar findings were reported by Bugwak (2021) in a qualitative study that documented out-of-field teachers' narratives describing struggles in maintaining discipline and student attention. Teachers reported difficulty establishing classroom authority and implementing effective teaching strategies when assigned outside their area of expertise. Their limited content mastery resulted in less engaging lessons, which weakened students' interest and attentiveness. As students perceived the teachers' lack of expertise, they were more likely to question the teachers' credibility and authority, further intensifying classroom management problems. Supporting this, Castro et al., (2023) found that low self-efficacy among teachers teaching non-specialized subjects weakens classroom authority, particularly when teachers lack confidence in handling both content delivery and student discipline.

Recent literature further supports classroom management as a persistent challenge among teachers teaching outside their specialization. Studies indicate that inadequate subject preparation divides teachers' attention between content mastery and behavior management, resulting in difficulty maintaining classroom order and engaging students effectively (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021; Ibrahim et al., 2025). Unfamiliarity with subject content reduces teachers' confidence, which weakens consistency in enforcing classroom rules and increases student misbehavior and disengagement (Salama et al., 2025). These challenges are especially pronounced in large and diverse classrooms, where effective management requires strong instructional clarity and well-established routines—areas in which non-specialized teachers often struggle (Zamayla & Labitad, 2025).

Despite these challenges, some studies present contrasting findings. Caneda and Biol, (2025) reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects were still capable of establishing positive classroom environments that supported learner diversity and active learning. Although these teachers experienced difficulties in content delivery, their pedagogical experience, training, and accumulated

teaching knowledge enabled them to manage classrooms effectively and create inclusive learning environments.

Other studies noted that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects employ various coping strategies to improve classroom management, such as establishing structured routines, using positive reinforcement, seeking peer support, and engaging in self-directed professional learning (Jayme & Tantiado, 2025). While these strategies help reduce classroom disruptions and improve student engagement, they are often insufficient to fully address classroom management challenges without adequate subject preparation and formal training (Badaru & Ndlovu, 2025).

Overall, the reviewed literature underscores that classroom management difficulties among teachers teaching non-specialized subjects are closely linked to limited subject knowledge, reduced self-efficacy, and weakened pedagogical content knowledge. These findings highlight the need for systematic institutional support, including targeted professional development, mentoring programs, and better alignment between teachers' specialization and teaching assignments to ensure effective classroom management and improved learning outcomes.

Support and Resources

Support and access to appropriate resources play a critical role in enhancing teachers' instructional effectiveness, particularly for those assigned to teach non-specialized subjects. Rodriguez (2025) emphasized that teachers teaching outside their field of specialization frequently encounter challenges related to insufficient institutional support and limited access to instructional resources. The study revealed that these teachers often lack subject-specific teaching materials, instructional guides, and professional development opportunities tailored to the subjects they handled.

Several local and international studies corroborate these findings. Magdaraog and Benavides, (2020) reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in Sorsogon experienced difficulties due

to limited resources, insufficient training, and lack of equipment, prompting them to rely on peer consultation as a coping strategy. Similarly, Magtulis & Brunio,(2025) found that lack of school-based assistance and the need for innovative instructional strategies were the most pressing institutional concerns among science teachers teaching outside their specialization. These findings were supported by Tope (2023), who emphasized that schools must provide adequate resources and support systems to help non-specialized teachers manage workload effectively and reduce stress and burnout.

The literature also highlights the evolving learning needs of teachers assigned to non-specialized subjects. Hobbs (2020) identified five categories of learning needs that shift over time among out-of-field teachers, underscoring the importance of contextual and sustained institutional support. Without such support, teachers struggle to adapt to unfamiliar content demands and changing curricular expectations.

Recent studies further reveal that inadequate resources and support negatively impact both teaching effectiveness and student learning outcomes. Ciata et al., (2024) documented that insufficient training and limited access to instructional resources hinder teachers' instructional quality and students' academic performance. Gaso, (2025) similarly noted that administrative decisions and teacher shortages often compel educators to teach non-specialized subjects without adequate institutional preparation. This support gap extends to technical resources and equipment, as Dela Cruz et al. (2025) found that non-Technical and Livelihood Education (TLE) teachers faced significant challenges due to insufficient tools and materials when teaching TLE subjects.

Research consistently affirms that adequate support systems are essential in helping teachers adapt to the demands of teaching outside their specialization. Studies show that non-specialized teachers experience strain due to limited instructional materials, inadequate equipment, and lack of targeted professional development, which restrict effective lesson planning and delivery (Caspe & Sarrosa, 2025;

Dela Cruz et al., 2025; Saldivar, 2024). For instance, Dela Cruz et al. (2025) highlighted that insufficient access to subject-specific tools, collaborative networks, and mentoring support contributes to reduced confidence and instructional effectiveness among non-TLE teachers. Similarly, Caspe and Sarrosa (2025) emphasized that institutional support mechanisms—such as teacher preparation programs, orientation sessions, and resource allocation—are critical determinants of teachers' readiness to implement new curricular demands.

Moreover, professional development and mentoring are identified as pivotal resources in supporting teachers' adaptation and professional growth in non-specialized teaching roles. Studies indicate that targeted professional development programs and mentorship significantly enhance teachers' pedagogical skills, self-efficacy, and resilience, enabling them to manage unfamiliar curriculum content and diverse learner needs more effectively (Dreer-Goethe, 2025; Saldivar, 2024). Hobbs et al. (2026) further recommended ongoing learning opportunities that integrate cross-disciplinary pedagogies, peer collaboration, and reflective practice to strengthen teachers' confidence and instructional competence in new subject areas.

Overall, the reviewed literature underscores that systematic institutional support—through adequate resource provision, targeted professional development, mentoring, and supportive leadership—is indispensable in enabling teachers to adapt successfully to non-specialized teaching assignments. Providing such support minimizes the negative effects of subject mismatch, enhances instructional effectiveness, and promotes teacher well-being and instructional sustainability despite contextual challenges.

Psychological Challenges

Several empirical studies highlight that teaching non-specialized subjects not only affects instructional quality but also the teacher's mental and emotional state. Findings of Ogundairo, (2024)

revealed that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experience notable psychological and professional challenges, yet they also demonstrate strong coping abilities and resilience. Teachers teaching non-specialized subjects reported feeling stress, anxiety, and self-doubt due to teaching subjects they were not trained. They expressed constant fear of being judged by students or colleagues and frustration over the extra workload required to prepare lessons.

Similarly, (Hobbs and Porsch, (2021) reported that teachers teaching outside their specialization often feel frustrated due to institutional pressure to achieve positive learning outcomes. This pressure compels them to master unfamiliar subject content while simultaneously meeting expectations for effective instruction, which can undermine their motivation and self-efficacy. In the same vein, Nakar & Du Plesis (2023) found that teachers teaching subjects they are less familiar with tend to experience higher stress levels and reduced confidence, particularly when their qualifications do not align with the performance criteria used to evaluate their work.

Further reinforcing these findings, Anselmo et al., 2024) emphasized that teaching non-specialized subjects is closely associated with psychological challenges such as insecurity, uncertainty about subject matter, and difficulty understanding unfamiliar content. These factors contribute to emotional distress, including heightened stress and anxiety. However, Anselmo and colleagues also noted that teachers attempt to mitigate these challenges through adaptive strategies such as increased lesson preparation, reliance on peer support, effective workload management, and participation in continuous professional development.

Focusing on early-career educators, Caldis (2022), in *Out-of-Field Teaching: New Teachers Survive Under Pressure*, found that most new teachers felt overwhelmed by their out-of-field teaching assignments, with some reporting serious anxiety. This pressure was attributed to the dual responsibility of acquiring sufficient content knowledge while delivering effective instruction, further exacerbated by

classroom management demands. These findings align with Ogundairo, (2024) observation that out-of-field teachers frequently feel underprepared, overwhelmed by lesson planning, and insecure about their content knowledge. Over time, such persistent stress may lead to burnout, characterized by emotional exhaustion, cynicism, and reduced professional accomplishment (Maslach and Leiter 2016 as cited by Ogundairo 2024).

Adaptation

Teachers demonstrate remarkable adaptability when teaching non-specialized subjects through a combination of self-directed learning strategies, technological integration, and collaborative support systems. Moreover, Salvador et.al (2022), found that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects adapt to the challenges they encounter by relying on several key adaptations often focus on learning from seasoned teachers, learning from textbooks, learning from schemes of work, and training and seminars. Furthermore, Gomez & Petalla, (2025) highlighted that these teachers also using technology to navigate unfamiliar content and instructional demands, demonstrating that digital tools have become an essential component of their adaptation.

Research reveals that educators employ adaptive teaching methods and resourcefulness in instructional material development as their most common adaption (Magtulis and Brunio, 2025) utilizing extensive reading, internet research, and seeking help from colleagues (Pilar & Militante, 2020). Teachers successfully integrate technology such as YouTube videos, role-playing activities, and interactive board work to overcome content knowledge gaps Roxas, (2022) while also engaging in time and workload management, adapting teaching methods, and pursuing professional development opportunities (Tope, 2023). This adaptation process proves effective, with studies showing very high levels of adaptive strategies and performance among non-specialized teachers and notably, four out of ten teachers

eventually learning to appreciate handling non-specialized subjects (Candelario & Abo, 2025). The success of teacher adaptation is further enhanced when supported by professional development programs, mentorship, and access to teaching resources, which significantly mitigate challenges and improve teaching effectiveness (Espiritu & Espiritu, 2025).

Learning from seasoned teachers

Learning from seasoned teachers through mentoring, collaboration, and peer support emerges as a crucial adaptation and professional growth mechanism among teachers handling non-specialized subjects, particularly novice educators. Study of Salvador et al. (2022), in their study Exploring Technical-Vocational Education Teachers' Challenges and Adaptation Strategies in Teaching Courses Outside their Specialization, found that guidance from experienced teachers plays a significant role in helping out-of-field teachers adapt to instructional challenges. The study highlighted that seasoned teachers possess expertise, mastery, and extensive teaching experience, enabling them to share subject knowledge and effective instructional strategies. Through this support, teachers teaching non-specialized subjects gain confidence and develop a more positive perspective toward their assignments, recognizing learning as a continuous professional process.

Similarly, Caldis (2022), reported that novice teachers assigned to non-specialized subjects actively engage with experts and mentoring programs to cope with instructional demands. Quality mentoring and structured induction programs, often led by experienced teachers, significantly influence novice teachers' professional development and their decision to remain in the profession. These mentoring relationships help new teachers "gain their footing" and build confidence in instructional decision-making (Sydnor et al., 2024) . In the same vein, Abrantes & Bargamento, (2024) found that teachers who were not specialized in Physical Science benefited substantially from mentorship, guidance, and informal coaching provided by

experienced colleagues. Participants described peer mentoring and collaborative learning as essential supports that helped them manage instructional challenges and improve content delivery.

Mentorship also serves as an initial bridge that helps non-specialized teachers understand unfamiliar subject matter while reducing feelings of inadequacy commonly associated with out-of-field teaching (Abenes & Caballes, 2020). Supporting this view, De La Cruz and Alda (2024) found that English teachers teaching non-specialized subjects actively seek seasoned teachers not only for content clarification but also for access to teaching materials and practical instructional strategies. These findings suggest that mentorship is not a one-time intervention but a continuous, experience-based learning process that enables teachers to adjust to the demands of unintended teaching assignments.

Broader research further underscores the importance of learning from seasoned teachers as a critical support mechanism that helps novice and non-specialized teachers navigate the complexities of classroom practice and professional adaptation. Studies on mentoring and coaching emphasize that experienced educators act as role models and guides by providing practical knowledge, instructional strategies, and emotional support that foster professional growth (Galvez & Azarias, 2024). Mentoring relationships have been shown to enhance teachers' understanding of pedagogical practices, classroom management, and contextualized instruction, thereby increasing confidence and instructional effectiveness (Galvez & Azarias, 2024; Mwesigwa & Nakato, 2026). Additionally, research on teacher induction highlights that structured guidance from experienced teachers supports novice teachers in integrating theoretical knowledge with real classroom demands, leading to smoother transitions and sustained professional development (Wang, 2025; Dreer-Goethe, 2025).

The literature also reveals that learning from seasoned teachers contributes significantly to teacher resilience and professional identity formation. Mentorship not only strengthens instructional competence but also promotes reflective practice, emotional support, and a sense of belonging within the professional community—factors closely linked to teacher retention and job satisfaction (Mwesigwa &

Nakato, 2026; Dreer-Goethe, 2025). Beginning teachers in the Philippine education context, in particular, emphasize the value of experienced colleagues in navigating early-career challenges, adapting teaching strategies, and understanding school culture (Polinar & Gemota, 2025). Overall, sustained interaction with seasoned teachers through formal mentoring, peer coaching, or collaborative learning communities—emerges as a vital resource that enhances pedagogical competence, confidence, and professional resilience among teachers assigned to non-specialized subjects.

Learning from textbooks

Several studies have emphasized the crucial role of teaching resources and materials in supporting teachers who are assigned to teach subjects outside their specialization. Salvador et al. (2022) found that teachers assigned to teach non-specialized subjects adapt to the challenges they encounter by employing several key strategies, with a primary focus on learning from textbooks. The study revealed that textbooks serve as essential instructional resources that help out-of-field teachers build foundational content knowledge, structure lessons, and gain confidence in delivering unfamiliar subject matter. By relying on textbooks, teachers are better able to adapt with content gaps and manage the demands of teaching subjects outside their specialization.

The literature consistently highlights the importance of textbooks and instructional materials as essential coping and adaptation strategies for teachers assigned to non-specialized or out-of-field subjects. Perez, (2024) emphasized that teachers teaching beyond their area of expertise were able to enhance their content knowledge and instructional flexibility by utilizing books and other learning materials to bridge knowledge gaps. These teachers demonstrated resourcefulness by consulting subject experts and seeking relevant resources, which significantly improved their teaching effectiveness. Similarly, Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) found that increasing access to teaching resources and instructional materials ranked as the fourth most significant strategy (38% of responses) for improving the teaching experiences of non-

specialized teachers. Access to textbooks, online resources, educational tools, and supplementary materials enabled teachers to prepare lessons more effectively and deliver instruction with greater confidence.

In support of these findings, Edulan and Fajardo, (2024) reported that out-of-field teachers frequently relied on textbooks, supplementary materials, and digital platforms to facilitate effective teaching and learning. This practice not only enhanced instructional delivery but also improved students' understanding and engagement. Likewise, Hobbs and Porsch, (2021) observed that although teachers initially experienced a steep learning curve when teaching outside their specialization, they gradually developed confidence and competence through continuous preparation, reflection, and trial. Central to this process was the active use of instructional materials—particularly books—which helped teachers systematically build subject knowledge and strengthen their pedagogical skills and self-efficacy over time. Co et al., (2021) further found that Senior High School Science teachers teaching outside their specialization invested substantial time in studying content and compensating for knowledge gaps through the use of supplementary resources such as textbooks, videos, and online materials. This sustained engagement with instructional resources served as a key coping mechanism and contributed to teachers' overall pedagogical development.

Beyond empirical classroom practices, research underscores the foundational role of textbooks in instructional planning, particularly for teachers who lack deep content expertise. Textbooks provide structured guidance by outlining lesson objectives, content sequencing, and instructional tasks, enabling teachers to align instruction with curriculum standards while addressing gaps in subject knowledge (Vojíř & Rusek, 2022). In contexts where teachers face unfamiliar subject matter or limited planning time, textbooks serve as reliable scaffolds that support classroom management and lesson organization. Moreover, teacher–textbook interactions are dynamic rather than static; educators continuously interpret,

select, and adapt textbook content to meet learners' needs and contextual demands, thereby strengthening instructional decision-making (Kardas Isler, 2025).

In addition to serving as curriculum guides, textbooks and related instructional materials contribute to teachers' ongoing professional learning and adaptive teaching practices. Research indicates that effective teachers do not rely on textbooks rigidly; instead, they modify tasks, reorder content, and contextualize examples to enhance relevance and student engagement. Such adaptive use of textbooks encourages reflective practice and instructional flexibility, transforming prescribed content into meaningful learning experiences that accommodate diverse learner needs (Vojíř & Rusek, 2022). Consequently, textbooks function not only as learning tools for students but also as continuous professional support resources for non-specialized teachers, enabling them to manage content demands, enhance pedagogical competence, and navigate the challenges associated with teaching outside their field of specialization.

Learning from schemes of work

Schemes of work help teachers adapt by providing a structured framework for professional learning and instructional flexibility. Salvador et al. (2022) found that teachers assigned to teach non-specialized subjects adapt to the challenges they encounter by employing several key strategies, particularly by relying on schemes of work. The study revealed that schemes of work serve as essential planning tools that guide lesson sequencing, content coverage, and time allocation, enabling out-of-field teachers to organize instruction systematically. By using schemes of work, teachers are better able to manage unfamiliar subject content, align lessons with curriculum requirements, and reduce uncertainty in instructional planning, thereby helping them cope with the demands of teaching subjects outside their specialization.

The literature emphasizes the significant role of schemes of work as essential curriculum materials that support teachers' instructional planning and professional learning, particularly for those teaching non-specialized or out-of-field subjects. Moore et al., (2021) found that curriculum materials such as schemes of work catalyze changes in teachers' instructional practices by creating interconnected networks of professional development. Their study suggests that schemes of work are not merely static planning documents but dynamic tools that mediate between school practices and research-based insights, enabling teachers to align classroom instruction with curricular goals.

Supporting this perspective, Kimwarey, (2022) highlighted that the preparation of schemes of work is a crucial component of teacher training, although their implementation may vary across contexts. Hobbs and Porsch, (2021) further noted that newly hired teachers teaching non-specialized subjects particularly benefit from access to high-quality instructional materials, including schemes of work, alongside in-school mentoring structures. These researchers argue that schemes of work provide essential scaffolding for lesson preparation and classroom delivery, supporting teachers in curriculum planning while fostering adaptive expertise.

Related learning processes are also evident in the broader literature on out-of-field teaching. Pilar and Militante, (2020) identified "extensive reading and searching" and "internet resourcing" as strategies teachers use to acquire content knowledge for unfamiliar subjects. Similarly, Magtulis and Brunio, (2025) found that teachers employed resourcefulness in instructional material development and adaptive teaching methods when handling non-specialized subjects. Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) further emphasized that access to teaching resources and structured professional development programs significantly enhances teacher effectiveness in non-specialized teaching roles, reinforcing the importance of guided curriculum materials such as schemes of work.

Empirical studies also demonstrate a strong link between teachers' professional knowledge, instructional practices, and student academic performance. Findings indicate that preparation and

adherence to schemes of work, lesson plan development, mastery of content, syllabus coverage, and regular assessment practices positively influence students' examination scores. The majority of teacher respondents in these studies agreed that teachers' professional knowledge and its application—particularly through systematic use of schemes of work—significantly affect learners' academic achievement.

Moreover, research shows that schemes of work play a critical role in guiding instructional planning, especially for teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their specialization. Studies indicate that systematic preparation and effective utilization of schemes of work enhance lesson delivery, classroom organization, and learner engagement by ensuring coherent sequencing and consistent curriculum coverage (Maniriho & Zigira, 2025). For instance, research in primary school contexts revealed that teachers who regularly used well-prepared schemes of work demonstrated better instructional organization, higher student participation, and more effective syllabus completion than those who did not. These findings suggest that schemes of work help bridge gaps in content familiarity and planning skills, which is particularly beneficial for novice and non-specialized teachers.

Beyond instructional planning, the literature highlights the role of schemes of work in supporting professional learning and reflective practice. Moore et al. (2021) emphasized that when teachers engage collaboratively with schemes of work—through peer review, sharing, and revision—this process fosters reflective thinking about pedagogical choices and strengthens curriculum delivery skills. As teachers continually reference, adapt, and reflect on schemes of work across teaching cycles, they develop a deeper understanding of curriculum structure and student learning progressions, thereby increasing pedagogical confidence and adaptability, even in subjects outside their specialization. Overall, schemes of work function not only as planning tools but also as professional learning resources that support non-specialized teachers' ongoing development, instructional coherence, and resilience in diverse teaching contexts.

Training and Seminars

Training and seminars adaptation for teachers of non-specialized subjects requires targeted professional development, mentorship, and resource support to enhance teaching effectiveness. Salvador et al. (2022) found that teachers assigned to teach non-specialized subjects adapt to the challenges they encounter by employing several key strategies, with a strong focus on participating in training programs and seminars. The study revealed that professional development activities such as workshops, in-service training, and seminars provide out-of-field teachers with opportunities to strengthen content knowledge, acquire effective teaching strategies, and build confidence in handling unfamiliar subjects. Through continuous training and seminars, teachers are better equipped to cope with instructional demands, align their practices with curriculum standards, and enhance overall teaching effectiveness despite teaching outside their area of specialization.

The literature consistently underscores the importance of training and seminars as essential adaptation for teachers assigned to teach non-specialized or out-of-field subjects. Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) found that professional development programs, mentorship, and increased access to teaching resources significantly mitigate the challenges faced by non-specialized teachers. Building on this, Magtulis and Brunio, (2025) recommended targeted interventions such as teacher exchange programs, interdisciplinary training, and peer mentoring to strengthen teachers' instructional adaptability. Similarly, Julia et al., (2020) demonstrated through action research that focused training programs enable non-specialist teachers to develop foundational subject knowledge and improve teaching skills through the use of instructional media and educational applications. These findings highlight the growing recognition that many teachers are required to teach beyond their area of expertise, emphasizing the urgent need for systematic training adaptations to ensure effective instruction across subject areas (Castro et al., 2024).

Research further affirms that professional development activities such as workshops, seminars, and in-service training play a critical role in helping teachers respond to new instructional demands, particularly when teaching unfamiliar content. Studies indicate that participation in targeted training enhances teachers' pedagogical knowledge, instructional strategies, and confidence in managing diverse classroom challenges, including content unfamiliarity (Sacote Labadan & Tantiado, 2025; & Perez, 2024). Moreover, evidence suggests that teachers who engage in relevant seminars demonstrate improvements in teaching performance, classroom management, and instructional planning, which are crucial competencies for non-specialized teachers navigating subjects outside their original training (Sacote Labadan & Tantiado, 2025).

However, the literature also identifies barriers that limit the effectiveness of professional development initiatives. Studies report that limited access to training opportunities, misalignment between seminar content and actual classroom needs, and the prevalence of generic rather than context-specific programs reduce the potential impact of training and seminars on teaching practice (Philippine Institute for Development Studies [PIDS], 2024; Chin et al., 2022). These challenges suggest that while training is essential, its design and relevance are critical factors in determining its effectiveness for non-specialized teachers.

Beyond immediate instructional support, ongoing participation in training and seminars contributes to teachers' long-term professional growth and adaptability. Continuous professional development (CPD) programs that address pedagogy, content updates, and inclusive practices enable teachers to refine their skills, adopt innovative instructional approaches, and respond more effectively to diverse learner needs (Sacote Labadan & Tantiado, 2025; Sayman et al., 2025). Research further indicates that sustained, contextually relevant professional development—particularly programs that incorporate

active learning rather than one-time training events—is strongly associated with improved teaching effectiveness (Sayman et al., 2025; Amemasor et al., 2025). When seminars directly address classroom realities, such as large class sizes, differentiated instruction, or technology integration, teachers are better equipped to bridge content gaps, adapt to curriculum changes, and facilitate meaningful learning experiences (PIDS, 2024; Ortega Dela Cruz & Perez, 2024).

Overall, the literature suggests that access to well-designed training and seminar opportunities serves not only as immediate instructional support but also as a vital mechanism for continuous adaptation, professional resilience, and instructional effectiveness among teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.

Using technology to navigate

Teachers are increasingly relying on technology as a critical navigational tool when teaching subjects outside their area of expertise. Gomez and Petalla, (2025) highlighted that teachers adapt to challenges in non-specialized teaching by engaging in online research to access valid and reliable information. Similarly, Arendain & Limpot, (2022) emphasized that teachers handling unfamiliar subjects must conduct thorough research to ensure accuracy and relevance in lesson delivery.

Empirical evidence demonstrates that teachers use a range of ICT tools to facilitate teaching in non-specialized areas. For instance, Roxas, (2022) identified tools such as YouTube videos, role-playing, board works, and class reporting as strategies that support lesson planning, activity preparation, and content mastery in unfamiliar subject areas. Magtulis & Brunio, (2025) further found that technology-supported adaptation is among the most commonly employed strategies for science teachers teaching outside their specialization, emphasizing resourcefulness in instructional material development through digital platforms. Similarly, Tingzon and Buyok, (2022) revealed that non-TLE teachers extensively use technology for class discussions, skill demonstrations, and accessing required information, showing that

digital tools function as primary coping strategies for educators lacking specialized knowledge. Dela Cruz et al., (2025) also emphasized technology integration as a key strategy to empower non-TLE teachers, enabling collaborative growth and addressing resource limitations. Supporting this, Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) found that access to technological teaching resources significantly mitigates challenges faced by teachers in non-specialized roles, directly enhancing their teaching effectiveness across unfamiliar subjects.

Research further demonstrates that technology has become a key navigational strategy for teachers coping with instructional challenges, particularly in contexts accelerated by the shift to digital learning during the COVID-19 pandemic. Digital tools support lesson planning, content delivery, student engagement, and assessment, helping teachers bridge gaps in subject knowledge and instructional resources (Ishak et al., 2022). Systematic reviews of technology adoption in education highlight the benefits of digital tools for streamlining instructional tasks and supporting differentiated teaching. However, these studies also point to persistent challenges such as limited access to technology, insufficient training, and teachers limited digital competence, which can complicate integration efforts—especially for non-specialized teachers facing content mastery gaps (Systematic Literature Review on Technology Adoption, 2025). De Guia and Solomon (2024) emphasized that technology alone does not automatically improve instructional practice; targeted professional development is necessary to ensure meaningful use of digital tools in classrooms.

The literature further underscores that technology use supports professional growth when coupled with digital competence development and supportive environments. Caratiquit and Javier (2025) found that teachers with strong digital skills and techno-efficacy are more likely to use technology confidently and creatively, enhancing their ability to manage unfamiliar content and diverse learner needs. Advanced technologies, including AI, adaptive learning platforms, and multimedia tools, are increasingly recognized for their potential to personalize instruction, foster student engagement, and support learner-

centered strategies (Y. Zou, 2025). However, persistent barriers—such as rapid technological updates, lack of infrastructure, and insufficient time for mastery—highlight the need for ongoing professional development to ensure that teachers can adapt effectively to technology-enhanced teaching demands (Pedagogical Readiness for Digital Innovation, 2025).

Overall, the literature suggests that technology serves as a valuable navigational tool for non-specialized teachers, enabling them to access content, plan lessons, and deliver instruction effectively. To realize its full potential, technology integration must be accompanied by structured training, teacher support, and capacity-building initiatives, ensuring that educators can leverage digital tools for both immediate instructional adaptation and long-term professional development.

Teachers Profile

The teachers' profiles are important parts of this study, as they provide valuable insights into the challenges teachers encounter and the ways they adapt to address them. Several studies support the idea that teachers' experiences with challenges and their ability to adapt to classroom and workplace changes are influenced by factors such as sex, level of education, years of teaching, area of specialization, the subject outside their specialization, and school location.

Sex

The review shows that gender plays a minimal role in determining the level of challenges or the adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. Studies such as Beley (2025) and Candelario & Abo (2025) include gender in their teacher profiles but report no statistically significant differences between male and female teachers in challenge intensity or adaptation. According to Badaru & Ndlovu (2025), across the studies reviewed, gender has been consistently treated as a demographic descriptor rather than a determinant variable. Consequently, there is negligible empirical evidence to support the

notion that male and female teachers differ in the degree of difficulty they face when teaching outside their specialization, or in how they adapt to such conditions.

Qualification

Teacher qualifications play a significant role in affecting both the problems that teachers face and the changes they make. According to research such Rutgers et al. (2025), teachers with advanced degrees or professional training are better at mastering the subject matter and adapting their teaching methods, making the challenges of teaching subjects outside their primary area of expertise less severe. Study of Villano-ac (2024) found that teachers with advanced degrees or additional certifications were more flexible, confident, and able to handle subjects outside their primary areas of expertise. Having more education gives teachers more teaching tools, a better understanding of their subjects, and more confidence in their own abilities, which helps them do their non-specialized teaching jobs better.

Years of Teaching

Research has repeatedly shown that teachers' experience is a key factor in how well they adapt when put in charge of classes outside their primary area of expertise. In Ghana Agormedah et al., (2022) discovered that teachers with more years of experience were much more confident in their ability to use effective teaching methods, keep students interested, and run a well-organized classroom. Suggesting that teachers' confidence and ability to adapt are raised by the knowledge they have gained over time. Similarly, Orakci et al. (2023) reported that experienced teachers tend to build stronger self-efficacy through reflective practices and problem-solving approaches. Study of Pressley et al., (2023) also found that teachers with more experience felt greater control of their lessons and more confident, even during the pandemic demonstrating how established routines can help maintain stability in uncertain situations.

Additionally, Wheeley et al. (2023) on the other hand, reported that new and aspiring teachers often struggled in out-of-field situations because they lacked sufficient subject knowledge or classroom experience. All of these studies strongly suggest that the number of years a teacher has been working directly affects how they handle challenges and tasks outside their primary area of expertise.

Area of Specialization

One of the most important factors determining both the level of difficulty and the student's ability to adapt is the teacher's original area of expertise. Study of Candelario & Abo (2025), shows that when teachers are assigned subjects outside their primary area of expertise, they have more work to do, feel more stressed, and have less confidence in their ability to teach the material. These problems happen because teachers are not adequately trained about the subject. However, this mismatch between specialization and assignment also encourages proactive adaptation behaviors, such as working with peers, planning lessons for more extended periods, and learning professionally on your own . Villano-ac (2024), found that teachers' hard work and years of experience in their fields greatly help students learn new information, skills, and attitudes. Helping the country grow by making students globally competitive with 21st-century skills. Every student should get a free, high-quality education at every level.

Subjects Handled out of Specialization

Along with specialization, the number and types of subjects that teachers have to teach make the problems they face even worse. According to Dela Cruz et al. (2025) and Fullido (2025), teachers who teach more than one non-specialized subject experience greater content-related stress and greater difficulty managing their workload than teachers who teach only their specialization.

Studies in Southeast Asia underscore similar issues. Sari and Wulandari, (2025) states that in due to a persistent shortage of subject-specialist teachers in Indonesia, particularly in rural areas, many

teachers have been required to teach subjects outside their areas of specialization, resulting to lower-quality instruction and uneven student outcomes. This finding is similar to the study of Ng, (2019) and Lim and Wang, (2025) in Malaysia, which revealed that assigning teachers to handle subjects out of specialization continues due to insufficient staffing. In Thailand, (Hallinger and Bryant (2020) and Klanrit and Sroinam,2022) emphasized ongoing reforms and the decentralization of education have made teachers responsible for many subjects—often those beyond their primary areas of expertise—making it more challenging to maintain high teaching standards, particularly in subjects such as Physical Education and Social Studies.

In the Philippines, study of Abanilla et al. (2023 and Parreño et al. (2025) in Iloilo City, many teachers assigned to handle new curricular demands even though they have not received any specialized training. A similar pattern can be seen in the study of Dela Cruz et al. (2025) in Batangas, where a shortage of qualified teachers and a broad K–12 curriculum have forced many teachers to teach subjects they are unfamiliar with. Studies show that assigning teachers to subjects they do not know much about makes lessons less effective, reduces students' interest, and may worsen educational inequality, especially in communities that are already struggling and have few resources (Darling-Hammond (2020); Martinez & Sanchez, (2025). When teachers' qualifications do not match their assignments, lessons are less consistent, teachers are less confident, and it is harder for students to learn and acquire the skills they need.

School Location

School location is identified as one of the intervening factors that influence how teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experience and adapt. Badaru and Ndlovu (2025) review revealed that teaching non-specialized subjects is most common in rural schools with limited resources. Similar findings were reported in the study published in the International Journal of Research and Innovation in Social Science, which highlighted that teachers in remote areas face logistical challenges, resource shortages, and

isolation (Fabrigas & Paglinawan, 2025) .The lack of instructional resources, professional support, and access to continuous training makes it more difficult for teachers to handle subjects beyond their primary areas of expertise. According to Van Nuland et al. (2020) remote teaching often suffers from inadequate infrastructure. Teachers face challenges like unreliable internet access and limited teaching materials. And teachers in remote areas report feelings of isolation due to distance from family and colleagues.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

Teaching non-specialized subjects presents a multidimensional experience that demands pedagogical flexibility, professional resilience, and adaptive capacity. The study, *"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects,"* is grounded in several educational, psychological, and sociological theories that explain how teachers experience and manage instructional assignments beyond their field of expertise.

At the core of this study is the Person–Environment Fit (PE Fit) Theory (Caplan, 1987), which asserts that an individual's job satisfaction and performance are highly influenced by the congruence between their personal characteristics such as skills, values, and abilities and the demands, resources, and culture of their work environment. PE fit occurs when personal attributes align with organizational demands, producing positive outcomes such as engagement, motivation, and efficacy. Conversely, misalignment or "misfit" arises when personal characteristics differ from the requirements of the environment, triggering behavioral, cognitive, and affective responses such as stress, lowered self-efficacy, and professional discomfort (De Cooman et al., 2022). In educational contexts, teachers assigned to non-specialized subjects frequently experience such a misfit, as their training and expertise may not align with the curriculum demands. PE Fit Theory further highlights that individuals engage in adaptive strategies

such as professional development, peer learning, mentoring, and targeted training to bridge gaps between their abilities and environmental expectations, restore equilibrium, and improve performance (Edulan & Fajardo, 2024; Salvador et al., 2022).

Complementing this perspective is Role Theory (Biddle, 1986), which explains human behavior in terms of social roles expected behaviors tied to specific positions. Stress and conflict occur when role expectations are incompatible, unclear, or misaligned with an individual's preparation or capacity to perform. In the teaching profession, being assigned to teach subjects outside one's area of expertise can generate role conflict, as teachers are expected to fulfill duties for which they may not be adequately prepared. Supporting this, Deng et al. (2022) found that teachers experiencing role ambiguity—unclear expectations and misaligned responsibilities reported lower role enactment and higher role stress. This mirrors the experiences of teachers handling non-specialized subjects, where the mismatch between assigned tasks and personal expertise creates tension and necessitates adaptive coping strategies.

Importantly, these theoretical frameworks not only explain the challenges of teaching outside one's specialization but also provide a foundation for teacher development. By linking the PE Fit and Role theories to professional growth, educators and school leaders can identify strategies to support teachers in aligning their skills and expertise with their teaching assignments. For example, structured professional development programs, mentoring, training workshops, and collaborative learning opportunities serve as mechanisms to enhance teachers' content knowledge, pedagogical skills, and self-efficacy, thereby reducing misfit and role conflict (Espiritu & Espiritu, 2025; Castro et al., 2024; Julia et al., 2020). These interventions help teachers not only cope with the immediate demands of teaching non-specialized subjects but also foster long-term professional growth, reflective practice, and resilience. By applying adaptive strategies informed by these theories, teachers can gradually reconcile their personal skills with

professional expectations, improving instructional effectiveness and overall job satisfaction (Salvador et al., 2022; Magtulis & Brunio, 2025).

In conclusion, the Person–Environment Fit Theory and Role Theory provide a comprehensive framework for understanding how teachers experience and manage instructional assignments beyond their specialization. These theories illuminate both the challenges of misalignment and ambiguity, as well as the strategies through which teachers develop professionally. By incorporating adaptive practices such as professional development, mentoring, and collaborative learning, these frameworks guide interventions aimed at enhancing teachers' capacity to grow, learn, and respond effectively to the complexities of teaching non-specialized subjects.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

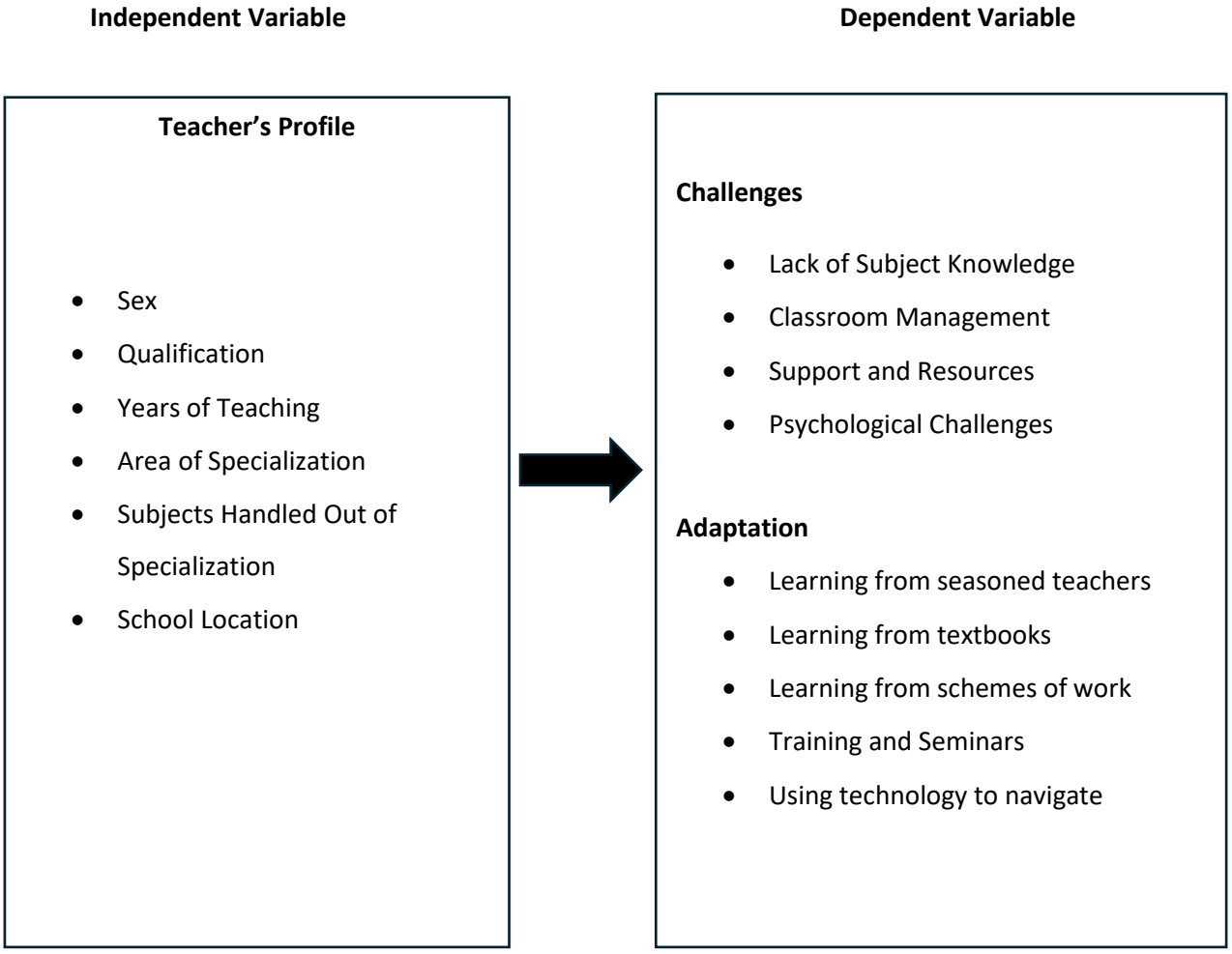


Figure 1: The figure shows the interplay of the variables of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

The researchers aimed to determine the challenges and adaptations of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. Specifically, this study aims to answer the following research questions;

1. What is the demographic profile of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in terms of:

    1.1 Sex;

    1.2 Qualification;

    1.3 Years of Teaching;

    1.4 Area of Specialization;

    1.5 Subjects Handled Out of Specialization; and

    1.6 School Location?

2. What is the level of challenges experienced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in terms of:

    2.1 Lack of Subject Knowledge;

    2.2 Classroom Management;

    2.3 Support and Resources; and

    2.4 Psychological Challenges?

3. What is the level of adaptation employed by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in terms of:

    3.1 Learning from seasoned teachers;

    3.2 Learning from textbooks;

    3.3 Learning from schemes of work;

    3.4 Training and Seminars; and

    3.5 Using technology to navigate?

4. Is there significant difference in the challenges faced by teachers teaching non- specialized subjects across their profiles?
5. Is there significant difference in the adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across profiles?
6. Is there a significant relationship between the challenges faced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and their adaptation?

1.6 Hypothesis of the Study

The following hypothesis guided by the study and tested at a 0.05 level of significance.

H_{o1}: There is no significant difference in the challenges faced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across profiles.

H_{o2}: There is no significant difference in the adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across profiles.

H_{o3}: There is no significant relationship between the challenges faced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and their adaptation.

Scope and Limitations

This study will examine the challenges and adaptation of teachers who will be assigned to teach subjects outside their field of specialization in BUENASCAR, Agusan del Norte. Specifically, the study will focus on selected public and private secondary school teachers from the following institutions: School A (15 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School B (10 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School C (20 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School D (9 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School E (30 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), and School F (5 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects). In total, these schools will have 89 identified teachers, all of whom will be selected as respondents in the study.

The study will also examine the primary challenges that will be experienced by teachers in BUENASCAR, Agusan del Norte, including a lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, support and resources, and psychological challenges. Furthermore, it will examine the adaptation that teachers will employ, including learning from seasoned teachers, learning from textbooks, learning from schemes of work, training and seminars, and using technology to navigate.

This study will exclusively utilize a pre-determined survey questionnaire as its data-gathering tool. As a result, specific challenges experienced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and the full extent of their adaptation may not be fully captured or explored. In addition, the sample size will be relatively small, which may influence the generalizability of the findings to a broader population of teachers. Furthermore, since the study will be conducted within selected schools in the BUENASCAR

municipalities, the results may have limited applicability to other educational contexts with different demographic compositions, institutional cultures, or available resources.

1.7 Definition of Terms

The following terms were operationally defined for a more precise and better understanding of the study.

Adaptation. This refers to the specific strategies and instructional adjustments respondents employ to effectively teach non-specialized subjects despite challenges in content mastery, classroom management, support and resources, and psychological challenges.

Area of Specialization. This refers to the academic discipline or subject field in which a respondent's has received formal education, training, or certification, as self-reported in the demographic section of the survey questionnaire, and used in the study to determine whether the subjects assigned to respondents are within or outside their field of specialization for analyzing challenges and adaptations.

Challenges. This term refers to the extent and type of difficulties respondents will report experiencing while teaching subjects outside their field of specialization, as measured through questionnaire items on content mastery, classroom management, availability of support, and psychological well-being.

Classroom Management. This describes the level at which respondents teaching non-specialized subjects will report their ability to control student behavior, organize classroom activities, manage time, and maintain a conducive learning environment, as indicated by their survey responses.

Lack of Subject Knowledge. This refers to the degree of insufficient content mastery that respondents will report when teaching non-specialized subjects, as measured by questionnaire items assessing their confidence in lesson preparation, explanation of concepts, and response to students' questions.

Learning from Schemes of Work. This refers to the frequency and extent to which respondents teaching non-specialized subjects will report using official schemes of work, curriculum guides, or lesson plans to structure and deliver instruction, as indicated in the survey questionnaire.

Learning from Seasoned Teachers. This refers to respondents reported practice of consulting, collaborating with, or receiving mentoring from experienced colleagues as an adaptation when teaching non-specialized subjects, as measured through survey items on peer assistance and professional collaboration.

Learning from Textbooks. This describes respondent's reliance on prescribed or supplementary textbooks to understand unfamiliar subject content and guide lesson delivery in non-specialized subjects, as reflected in their responses to the questionnaire.

Psychological Challenges. This refers to respondent's self-reported emotional and mental experiences such as stress, anxiety, pressure, or reduced self-confidence resulting from teaching subjects outside their specialization, as measured by selected survey items.

Qualification. This denotes respondent's highest educational attainment and professional credentials, as self-reported in the demographic section of the questionnaire and used to analyze variations in experienced challenges and adaptations.

Sex. This refers to the biological classification of respondent's as male or female, as indicated in the demographic profile of the respondents and used as a variable in the analysis.

School Location. This refers to the geographical classification of the school as urban or rural, as identified in the study and considered in examining differences in access to resources and support for respondent's teaching non-specialized subjects.

Subjects Handled Out of Specialization. This refers to the number and type of subjects that respondent's will report teaching outside their academic or professional field of specialization, as indicated in the survey questionnaire.

Support and Resources. This pertains to respondent's perceived availability and adequacy of instructional materials, facilities, administrative support, and institutional assistance provided to respondents teaching non-specialized subjects, as measured through survey items.

Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects. This refers to respondent's who will report being assigned to teach one or more subjects outside their formal academic training or area of specialization during the conduct of the study.

Training and Seminars. This refers to respondent's participation in professional development activities related to teaching non-specialized subjects, as measured by the frequency and perceived usefulness of training and seminars reported in the questionnaire.

Using Technology. This refers to respondent's use of digital tools, online resources, and educational platforms to enhance their understanding and delivery of non-specialized subjects.

Years of Teaching. This indicates the total number of years respondent's will report having been engaged in professional teaching, as recorded in the demographic profile and used to analyze its relationship with challenges and adaptations.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the research design, research materials and methods, research environment, population and sample, data analysis plan, and ethical standards.

2.1 Research Design

This study will employ a quantitative approach, utilizing a descriptive-comparative research design and correlational approaches to systematically investigate the challenges and adaptations of teachers teaching outside their area of specialization. The descriptive-comparative design is appropriate for this study because it directly addresses the objectives of the research, which aim to determine the levels of challenges and adaptation strategies of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and to compare these levels across different teacher profile variables. Through this design, the study will be able to describe existing conditions and objectively compare variations in challenges and adaptation based on sex, qualification, years of teaching, area of specialization, subjects handled out of specialization, and school location without manipulating any variables. This approach is suitable since the study seeks to answer objectives focused on identifying differences and patterns among groups as they naturally occur rather than establishing cause-and-effect relationships. Additionally, the correlational component will examine the relationship between the challenges encountered and the adaptation strategies employed by these teachers, further addressing the study's objectives.

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted in selected public and private high schools located in the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen (collectively referred to as BUENASCAR) in the province

of Agusan del Norte, Caraga Region. Specifically, the study sites will include the following schools: School A, Purok 4, Brgy. Matabao, Agusan del Norte with the (8.97° North latitude and 125.42° East longitude), School B, in Brgy. 3 Buenavista, Agusan del Norte with the (8.975° North latitude and 125.410° East longitude), School C, in Bayview Hill, Barangay 7, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte with the (8°59'N, 125°20'E), School D, D-3 Culit, Nasipit Agusan del Norte with the (8.94° North latitude and 125.36° East longitude), School E, Cabatuan Carmen, Agusan del Norte with the (8.4698° N, 124.6319° E), and School F, which is located at General Luna St. Poblacion, Carmen, Agusan del Norte with the (8.99° North latitude and 125.29° East longitude). These schools were purposively selected because they represent a mix of public and private secondary institutions within the BUENASCAR area. These schools have been identified as having teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their fields of specialization, making them appropriate sites for investigating the challenges and adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. Additionally, these schools were chosen because a previous study, "The Challenges of Physical Education Teachers Teaching Non-P.E." (Descriptive-comparative approach) was also conducted in the same institutions.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study's respondents will be selected using a purposive sampling technique, specifically the total population sampling method, since all teachers teaching non-specialized subjects identified in the selected schools will be included as respondents. Teachers from selected private and public schools in BUENASCAR Agusan del Norte will be chosen by the researchers. As Aguinaldo (2021) explained, purposive sampling helps researchers access a specific group of individuals who fit a given profile. Therefore, in this study, the researchers selected participants based on their suitability to provide the required responses.

This study has a total of eighty-nine (89) respondents, where fifteen (15) teachers from School A, ten (10) teachers from School B, twenty (20) teachers are from School C, nine (9) teachers from School D,

thirty (30) teachers from School E, and five (5) teachers from School F. These numbers will represent the teachers who will participate in the study, ensuring that the results will reflect their experiences.

Table 1

Number of Teachers teaching non-specialized per School

School	Number of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects
School A	15
School B	10
School C	20
School D	9
School E	30
School F	5
Total	89

Note. This table shows the total number of teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their area of specialization in each participating school.

Research Instrument

The research instrument to be used in this study will be a survey questionnaire that is partially adapted and modified from the validated indicators and survey questionnaire developed by Rizzie D. Rodriguez (2025) in the article "Out-Of-Field Teaching in Rural Senior High Schools: Prevalence, Challenges, Support, and Impact on Job Satisfaction," published in Psychology and Education. While selected items were adopted and refined to align with the objectives of the present study, the indicators for psychological challenges and adaptation variables will be researcher-made to address factors not covered in the original instrument. These modifications were undertaken to ensure the instrument's relevance, clarity, and appropriateness to the current research context.

Selected items will be adopted and refined to align with the objectives of the present study, while the indicators for psychological challenges and adaptation variables will be researcher-made to address factors not covered in the original instrument. These modifications will be undertaken to ensure the instrument's relevance, clarity, and appropriateness to the current research context.

The questionnaire consists of three (3) major sections, with each section representing a specific category of variables relevant to the study: (1) Teacher's Profile; (2) Challenges; and (3) Adaptation.

Section 1:

Teachers profile – The purpose of this study is to determine the profile of teachers in terms of sex, educational qualification, years of teaching experience, area of specialization, subjects handled outside their specialization, and school location. It further aims to examine the relationship between these profile variables and teachers' effectiveness in teaching non-specialized subjects.

Section 2: Challenges

The challenges variables that will be examined in this study will be based on previous research to ensure validity and relevance. The challenges variables, including lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, and access to support and resources, and its indicators, will be adapted from the study of Rizzie D. Rodriguez (2025) in the article *"Out-Of-Field Teaching in Rural Senior High Schools: Prevalence, Challenges, Support, and Impact on Job Satisfaction,"* published in *Psychology and Education*. Additionally, psychological challenges will be incorporated from the study of Ogundario (2024) to capture factors affecting teachers' emotional and mental well-being. Together, these variables will provide a comprehensive framework to assess the challenges faced by teachers in the context of this study.

Each part contains six (6) items, for a total of twenty- four (24). The respondents will answer each item using a 4-point Likert scale: 1- Strongly Disagree, 2- Disagree, 3-Agree, 4-Strongly Agree.

Part I: Lack of Subject Knowledge (6 items) This part focuses on the teachers' difficulty in mastering the content of subjects they were assigned to teach outside their specialization. Rodriguez (2025) described this as a core impediment in teaching non-specialized subjects, where teachers experience limited subject matter knowledge (SMK), which affects lesson planning, classroom delivery, and confidence. The items under this part capture teachers' struggles with lesson preparation, conceptual understanding, and ability to answer student questions, as well as the need for continuous professional development and mentoring to improve pedagogical content knowledge.

Part II: Classroom Management (6 items) This section measures how teachers teaching non-specialized subjects assignments influence teachers' ability to manage student behavior, maintain engagement, and establish authority in the classroom. According to Rodriguez (2025), OOF teachers often face difficulties in maintaining discipline and student participation because of uncertainty in the subject matter. These classroom management challenges may lead to low student motivation, reduced learning outcomes, and increased teacher frustration. This part reflects teachers' perceptions of their classroom control, ability to engage students, and confidence in handling subject-related behavior issues.

Part III: Support and Resources (6 items) This part explores teachers' access to institutional support, instructional materials, mentorship, and professional development opportunities. Rodriguez (2025) reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects often face inadequate resources and limited training, leading to feelings of isolation and lack of administrative support. Items in this section evaluate the availability and adequacy of teaching materials, collaboration opportunities, training relevance, and administrative responsiveness. The data in the original study indicated that most teachers

rated existing support as only partially effective, highlighting a need for better-targeted assistance and continuous mentoring programs.

Part IV: Psychological Challenges (6 items) This section, developed by the researcher, measures emotional and psychological difficulties associated with out-of-field teaching — including stress, anxiety, self-doubt, and burnout. As Ogundario (2024) emphasized, teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experience emotional distress and decreased self-efficacy due to insecurity about their subject competence. Psychological strain manifests as fatigue, loss of motivation, and lowered job satisfaction. This part captures the teachers' mental and emotional well-being in relation to their teaching non-specialized subjects responsibilities, complementing the other three variables that focus on external and instructional challenges.

Section 3: Adaptation

In adaptation variable, the researchers will be utilized a researcher-made survey questionnaire. This questionnaire will be designed to gather quantitative data relevant to the objectives of the study. It will consist of structured items formulated based on a review of related literature and studies to ensure content validity and relevance. The instrument will be subjected to expert validation and pilot testing prior to its administration to ensure its reliability and clarity.

The questionnaire consists of four (5) major parts, with each part representing a specific category of teachers' adaptation identified in the review of literature: (1) Learning from seasoned teachers, (2) Learning from textbooks, (3) Learning from schemes of work, (4) Training and Seminars, Salvador et al. (2022), and (5) Using Technology, Gomez & Petalla (2022). Each part contains six (6) items, for a total of thirty (30). The respondents will answer each item using a 4-point Likert scale: 1- Strongly Disagree, 2-Disagree, 3-Agree, 4-Strongly Agree.

Part I: Learning from Seasoned Teachers (6 items) This section describes how teachers seek guidance and mentorship from experienced or veteran colleagues to cope with teaching subjects outside their specialization. According to Salvador et al. (2022), seasoned teachers play a crucial role in supporting less experienced teachers by sharing their expertise, teaching techniques, and classroom strategies. This adaptation fosters professional growth, confidence, and pedagogical improvement, helping teachers to adjust positively to new teaching environments. Through observation, mentoring, and constructive feedback, novice or teachers teaching non-specialized subjects acquire methodological and professional knowledge, and learn to accept challenges as opportunities for continuous learning.

Part II: Learning from Textbooks (6 items) This part focuses on how teachers utilize textbooks and instructional materials as primary learning resources when teaching unfamiliar subjects. Textbooks serve as structured guides that provide comprehensive lesson content, activities, and references. Salvador et al. (2022) highlighted that textbooks enable teachers to understand lesson flow, key concepts, and pedagogical approaches systematically. They also promote active learning and concept mastery, ensuring that teachers can deliver topics with greater confidence and accuracy. By relying on well-designed textbooks, teachers enhance both their subject matter knowledge and instructional efficiency, making them better prepared to meet students' learning needs.

Part III: Learning from Schemes of Work (6 items) This section measures how teachers adapt through collaboration and shared planning with colleagues, often guided by the school's *schemes of work*—standardized lesson frameworks outlining objectives, pacing, and content. The study emphasized that consulting peers and reviewing existing schemes of work helps teachers understand curriculum expectations and best practices. This process not only clarifies subject sequences and assessment methods but also encourages team learning and reflective practice, enhancing instructional confidence. By

integrating insights from experienced colleagues and structured schemes, teachers can align their teaching with institutional standards and improve lesson coherence.

Part IV: Training and Seminars (6 items) This part assesses teachers' participation in formal professional development programs such as workshops, training sessions, and seminars. Salvador et al. (2022) found that these programs significantly improve teachers' competence, confidence, and innovation in teaching outside their specialization. Training provides opportunities for teachers to gain updated knowledge, explore teaching strategies, and exchange ideas with peers. It also enhances their ability to experiment with new methodologies, leading to improved classroom practices and motivation. Furthermore, professional training fosters career growth and morale, equipping teachers with essential skills for both content mastery and pedagogical adaptation.

Part V: Using technology to navigate (6 items) This section evaluates how teachers utilize technological tools and digital platforms as adaption in teaching subjects beyond their expertise. With the increasing integration of ICT in education, teachers turn to technology for lesson preparation, instructional delivery, and student engagement. Technology provides access to online resources, video tutorials, simulations, and interactive materials that enhance comprehension and lesson quality.

2.4 Data Gathering Procedure

The data will be ordered and analyzed through the following procedure:

Permission letter — Before the conduct of data gathering, we, as researchers, will seek formal permission from the Dean and have our research proposal and instruments reviewed and noted by our adviser to ensure ethical compliance, methodological soundness, and appropriateness for the study.

Letter of Approval—The researchers will initiate the data-gathering process by formally addressing a letter of approval to the principals of the selected schools. The letter will serve as a formal request for permission

to conduct the study within their respective schools. It will also seek authorization to obtain the list of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects who will serve as respondents.

Informed Consent—Before the distribution of the questionnaires, the researchers will provide the respondents with a clear explanation of the purpose of the study. Respondents will be required to sign an informed consent form before participating in the study.

Distribution of Survey Questionnaires—After securing approval and consent, the researchers will distribute the survey questionnaires to the identified teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in the selected schools. The questionnaire will be personally administered or distributed, depending on the accessibility and preference of the respondents.

Retrieval of Questionnaires—After the allotted response period, the researchers will personally retrieve the accomplished questionnaires from the respondents.

Gathering Data—The data collected from the retrieved questionnaires will be checked for completeness, tallied, and encoded for analysis. Results will be presented, analyzed, and interpreted using appropriate statistical tool

Data Analysis—The data will be statistically analyzed using descriptive statistics to summarize the respondent's profiles and responses. Inferential statistics, to determine significant differences across groups and the relationship between the challenges faced and the adaptation employed by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.

Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

The data will be statistically analyzed using descriptive statistics (mean, standard deviation, frequency, and percentage) to summarize the respondent's profiles and responses. Inferential statistics, such as the t-test and Analysis of Variance (ANOVA), will be used to determine significant differences across

groups. The Pearson r correlation will be employed to determine the relationship between the challenges faced and the adaptation employed by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

The researchers will uphold the highest ethical standards in the conduct of this study. They will take responsibility to respect and protect the rights and welfare of the respondents who will participate. The study will strictly follow established ethical guidelines to ensure honesty, integrity, and objectivity throughout the research process. It will also safeguard the respondents' privacy, confidentiality, and autonomy. The following ethical standards will guide this research:

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) - This research will not involve any new technology, process, or product that will require patent protection. It will respect and uphold intellectual property rights. To ensure this, the researchers will make certain that all materials to be used will be appropriately credited and protected under copyright laws. All third-party sources and secondary data will be properly acknowledged. Since the study will not create any brand, logo, or symbol, trademark registration will not be necessary.

B. Informed Consent - Before the study commences, the researcher will seek and obtain formal approval from the relevant authorities. This will include permission from the Schools Division Superintendent, Schools District Supervisor, and the heads of the different schools in BUENASCAR to ensure that the study will align with educational policies and regulations. This process will ensure that respondents will fully understand the study's purpose, procedures, possible risks, and benefits, allowing them to make an informed decision about their participation.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality - Respondents private information will be handled with the utmost confidentiality. Data will be collected through questionnaires, and codes will be used to maintain respondents' confidentiality. All data obtained will be stored in a secure, password-protected file that will be accessible only to the researcher and the adviser. No information will be shared with any other parties without the respondents' written consent.

D. Voluntary Participation - As part of the study, the researchers will ensure that respondents will not be forced to participate; their participation will be entirely voluntary. Respondents will be thoroughly informed of their right to withdraw from the research at any time without facing any negative consequences. This assurance will aim to create a comfortable and respectful environment, ensuring that respondents from BUENASCAR, Agusan del Norte, teaching non-specialized subjects will feel no obligation to continue if they choose not to. All responses will be collected with respondents' full permission, ensuring that they will be free to decide and feel safe and comfortable during the study.

E. Minimization of Harm - The study will pose minimal or no physical, emotional, or psychological risk to the respondents. The questionnaire items will be carefully designed to avoid causing discomfort, embarrassment, or professional sensitivity. However, if any respondent experiences unease or distress while answering the questionnaire, the researcher will allow the respondent to skip sensitive items or withdraw from the study without penalty. If a respondent refuses to answer the questionnaire, the researcher will respect their decision without pressure or consequence. The researcher will politely thank the respondent for their time and ensure that non-participation will not affect their professional standing, relationship with colleagues, or role in the institution. The researcher will fully cooperate in implementing corrective actions, such as revising the data collection process, securing additional consent, or providing referrals for professional or psychological support if necessary. If any respondent shows signs of stress or emotional distress during data collection, the researcher will immediately pause the session, provide reassurance, and allow the respondent time to rest. The researcher will also remind the respondents of their right to discontinue participation at any time and, if needed, refer them to appropriate counseling or support services within the institution.

F. Beneficence - The study will aim to provide valuable insights into the challenges and adaptations of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. The findings will be beneficial to school administrators,

education program developers, and policymakers in developing support mechanisms, professional development programs, and policy interventions that will enhance teacher performance and well-being. In addition, the respondents will be given access to a summary of the study's findings after the research is completed. This will allow them to understand the overall results, reflect on their professional experiences, and possibly apply some of the adaptive strategies identified in the study to improve their own teaching practices.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection- Respondents will be selected fairly and in accordance with inclusion criteria that will ensure diversity in teaching experience, gender, and subject area. No respondents will be excluded on the basis of age, gender, race, religion, or other personal background factors. The selection process will promote fairness and equal opportunity for all qualified respondents. Only teachers who will have one year or more of experience teaching non-specialized subjects will be included in the study.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy - Data collection and analysis will be carried out using standardized procedures to ensure accurate and reliable results. All outputs will be carefully reviewed to reduce errors or biases. The study will also acknowledge potential limitations, such as sample size or possible biases, to maintain the integrity of the research and to comply with all relevant guidelines on participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights. Additionally, all AI-generated content and outputs will be thoroughly reviewed to minimize errors and maintain objectivity, supporting the overall integrity of the research.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting - The results of this study will be reported accurately and truthfully, without altering or distorting the data. The researcher will acknowledge the importance of transparency and will openly disclose any potential conflicts of interest that could affect the study. All third-party materials will be accurately cited to maintain openness and uphold intellectual property rights.

For transparency, AI tools, such as ChatGPT, will be used to assist in organizing ideas, summarizing literature, and refining questionnaire items; however, the researcher will ensure that all AI-assisted outputs will be carefully validated and cross-checked to prevent errors, bias, or misinterpretation. This responsible use of AI will support the integrity and credibility of the study while maintaining full accountability for the research process. This commitment to integrity will safeguard the validity of the research and foster trust in the study's findings.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials - This study will utilize various resources, including copyrighted academic works and secondary data. The researchers will recognize the importance of respecting intellectual property rights and will obtain all necessary permissions before using any copyrighted materials. All resources will be carefully cited in the final report to ensure proper attribution and transparency. This commitment to ethical sourcing will uphold the integrity of the study and will acknowledge the contributions of the original authors, whose work will support this study.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials - In this study, all respondents in human trials will receive an informed consent form that will clearly explain the study's purpose, procedures, and potential risks and benefits. The informed consent process will emphasize that participation will be entirely voluntary, informing respondents of their right to withdraw at any time without consequences. This approach will ensure compliance with ethical standards outlined in relevant institutional and international guidelines for human subject research, thereby prioritizing the safety, dignity, and autonomy of all respondents. Support services will also be provided in case of emergency.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies - The study will incorporate AI tools and digital technologies to assist in various stages of the quantitative research process. ChatGPT will be utilized during the instrument development and preliminary analysis phase to organize ideas, refine questionnaire items, and summarize related literature. Microsoft Excel and SPSS will be used for encoding, organizing, and

analyzing the quantitative data. Grammarly will be used to ensure that the research report will adhere to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of these technologies will involve validating AI-assisted outputs, cross-checking statistical results, and ensuring that no AI tools will introduce bias or misinterpretation. Respondents will be informed about the use of these technologies to ensure full transparency and trust in the research process.

M. Ethical Approval - Ethical approval for the conduct of this study will be obtained from the Research Ethics Committee (REC) of Saint Michael College of Caraga prior to data gathering, confirming that the study will adhere to all relevant guidelines on participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

REFERENCES:

Abrantes, L. F., & Bargamento, A. L. (2024). *Lived Experiences of Out-Of-Field Senior High School Teachers Teaching Physical Science. International Journal of Multidisciplinary Educational Research and Innovation*, *2*(1), 117–143. https://doi.org/10.17613/r5pt-t937

Agormedah, E. K., Ankomah, F., Frimpong, J. B., Quansah, F., Srem-Sai, M., Hagan, J. E., & Schack, T. (2022). *Investigating Teachers' Experience and Self-Efficacy Beliefs Across Gender in Implementing the New Standards-Based Curriculum in Ghana. Frontiers In Education*, *7*, 932447. https://doi.org/10.3389/feduc.2022.932447

Anselmo, C. T., & Anselmo, C. (2024). *Algopsychalia Of Out-Of-Field Teachers: A Qualitative Inquiry. American Journal of Education and Technology*, *3*(3), 1–8. https://doi.org/10.54536/ajet.v3i3.2285

Arendain I, & Limpot M. (2022). *Phenomenological Approach of Out-Of-Field Teaching: Challenges and Opportunities. 8*(1). https://doi.org/10.36713/epra9379

Badaru, K. A., & Ndlovu, N. S. (2025). *Understanding The Out-Of-Field Teaching Experiences: A Review of Selected National Contexts. Interdisciplinary Journal of Education Research*, *7*(2), A04–A04. https://doi.org/10.38140/ijer-2025.vol7.2.04

Baras E, & Gillo A. (2024). *The Lived Experiences of Out-Of-Field Senior High School Teachers. 5*. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.13237627

Beley, N. B. (2025). *Out-Of-Field Teaching and Self-Efficacy: Its Influence to Teachers' Job Satisfaction.* In *Psych Educ* (Vol. 2025, Issue 4, Pp. 2025–4475). https://doi.org/10.70838/pemj.460409

Branzuela, M. J., Ayro, E. C., & Cruz-Vidal, M. J. DL. (2023). *Teaching Outside the Box: Senior High School Teaching Experiences, Challenges, and Windows of Innovations of Non-Social Science Majors. International Journal of Multidisciplinary: Applied Business and Education Research*, *4*(7), 2210–2222. https://doi.org/10.11594/ijmaber.04.07.06

Buenacosa Ma. S, & Petalla M. (2022). *Embracing the Unknown: Adaptability and Resiliency of Out-Of-Field Secondary Teachers Teaching English in Public Schools. Original Research Article Buenacosa and Petalla; Asian J. Educ. Soc. Stud*, *37*(2), 1–29. https://doi.org/10.9734/ajess/2022/v37i2796

Bugwak E. (2021). *Travails Of Out-Of-Field Teachers: A Qualitative Inquiry. 3*(2). https://doi.org/10.32996/jweep.2021.3.2.4

Caldis. (2022). *Out-Of-Field Teaching: New Teachers Survive Under Pressure | By Research Outreach | Medium.* https://doi.org/10.32907/ro-131-3015373943

Candelario C, M. & Abo. (2025). *Out-Of-Field Teaching Experiences of Science Teachers in Non-Specialized Subjects: A Phenomenological Study. 40*(3). https://doi.org/10.70838/pemj.400306.

Caneda, C. J. R. T., & Biol Jr., I. M. (2025). *The Competence of Out-Of-Field Teachers and Student Performance: Inputs for an Intervention Plan. Randwick International of Education and Linguistics Science Journal*, *6*(2), 441–460. https://doi.org/10.47175/rielsj.v6i2.1171

Castro, F. L. T., Ventura, B. L. O., Estajal, R. S., Timpangco-Macario, J., Limen, M. V., Garil, B. A., & Chavez, J. V. (2024). *Teachers Handling Multiple Subject Areas: Difficulties and Adaptive Attributes in the Delivery of Instructions. Environment And Social Psychology*, *9*(9). https://doi.org/10.59429/esp.v9i9.2520

Castro M, Asignado R, & Recede. (2023). *Out-Of-Field Teaching: Impact on Teachers' Self-Efficacy and Motivation. 4*(2). https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.11594/ijmaber..04.02.19

Ciata, R., Doblon, I., & Torreros, M. (2024). *"Navigating Challenges: A Study on the Impact of Non-Specialized Teachers in Edukasyon Sa Pagpapakatao (Values Education) In Samar Division." International Journal of Social Science and Human Research*, *7*(06). https://doi.org/10.47191/ijsshr/v7-i06-28

Co, A. G. E., Abella, C. R. G., & Jesus, F. S. De. (2021). *Teaching Outside Specialization from the Perspective of Science Teachers. Oalib*, *08*(08), 1–13. https://doi.org/10.4236/oalib.1107725

Dela Cruz G, Albastro R, Capangpangan K, Laborte E, Lomocso A, & Prieto C. (2025). *Echoing The Voices of Teachers Beyond Specialization: The Lived Experiences of Non-TLE Teachers in Teaching TLE Subjects. 51*(8), 395–411. https://journalajess.com/index.php/AJESS/article/view/2249.

Du Plessis, A., & Mcdonagh, K. (2021). *The Out-Of-Field Phenomenon and Leadership for Wellbeing: Understanding Concerns for Teachers, Students and Education Partnerships. International Journal of Educational Research*, *106*, 101724. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijer.2020.101724

Du Plessis A, E. (2019). *Barriers To Effective Management of Diversity in Classroom Contexts: The Out-Of-Field Teaching Phenomenon. 93*, 136–152. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijer.2018.11.002

Dursun, F., & Aykan, A. (2025). *Exploring Teachers' Narratives: Challenges And Strategies for Enhancing the Teaching Process. SAGE Open*, *15*(1). https://doi.org/10.1177/21582440251332557

Edulan, D. J. B., & Fajardo, M. T. M. (2024). *Challenges, Coping Mechanisms, Motivation, and Support Needs for Out-Of-Field Science Teachers in Western Mindanao. American Journal of Educational Research*, *12*(7), 271–281.https://doi.org/10.12691/education-12-7-8

Espiritu, M. C., & Espiritu, M. (2025). *Factors Affecting he Competence of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects: Basis for an Action Plan Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal Factors Affecting the Competence of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects:* Basis for an Ac…. *Psych Educ*, *2025*(1), 2025–3156. https://doi.org/10.70838/pemj.330210

Fullido M, C. (2025). *The Effects ƒ Teaching Outside Specialization in School 5*(5), 1294–1303. https://www.ijprems.com/uploadedfiles/paper/issue_5_may_2025/41417/final/fin_ijprems1748413083.pdf

Gaso, R. M. (2025). *Challenges Faced by Teachers Handling Non-Major Subjects: A Root Cause Study. Psychology And Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal*, *V33*(6), 701–711. https://doi.org/10.70838/pemj.330608

Gomez, S. P. P., & Petalla, M. B. (2025). *Navigating Uncharted Territory: Academic Journeys of Out-Of-Field Secondary Teachers Teaching Social Studies Subjects. Asian Journal of Education and Social Studies*, *51*(10), 677–691. https://doi.org/10.9734/ajess/2025/v51i102523

Hobbs L, & Porsch R. (2021). *Teaching Out-Of-Field: Challenges for Teacher Education*. *44*. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1080/02619768.2021.1985280

Javines R, K, & Azarias R. (2024). *Contexture of Out-Of-Field Teaching in Selected Public National High Schools: Implication for Practice and Policy Formulation*. *13*(18). https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.5861/ijrse.2024.24164

Fabrigas, A., & Paglinawan, J. L. (2025). *Beyond the Classroom: Challenges and Resilience of Teachers in Remote Schools.* https://doi.org/10.47772/ijriss

Julia, J., Supriyadi, T., & Iswara, D. (2020). *Training The Non-Specialist Music Teacher: Insights from an Indonesian Action Research Study. Universal Journal of Educational Research*, *8*(2), 547–558. https://doi.org/10.13189/ujer.2020.080226

Kimwarey, M. C. (2022). *Supervisors Responses on Preparation of Schemes of Work During Teaching Practice in Public Universities in Eldoret, Kenya. East African Journal of Education Studies*, *4*(1), 89–97. https://doi.org/10.37284/eajes.4.1.495

Luft, J. A., Hanuscin, D., Hobbs, L., & Törner, G. (2020). *Out-Of-Field Teaching in Science: An Overlooked Problem.* In *Journal of Science Teacher Education* (Vol. 31, Issue 7, Pp. 719–724). Taylor And Francis Ltd. https://doi.org/10.1080/1046560x.2020.1814052

Osman, V., & Villocino, R. P. (2024). *Teaching The Subject Content: A Phenomenological Inquiry of Out-Of-Field Teachers. 10*, 2024. Retrieved October 30, 2025, From www.ijariie.com

Magdaraog R, & Benavides N. (2020). *Profile, Challenges and Coping Mechanisms of Out-Of-Field Teachers in the Second Congressional District of Sorsogon*. https://www.ijsr.net/getabstract.php?paperid=sr20605080239

Magtulis, G. P., & Brunio, S. S. (2025). *Challenges And Coping Strategies of Science Teachers Handling Non-Specialized Subjects Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal Challenges and Coping Strategies of Science Teachers Handling Non-Specialized Subjects. Psych Educ*, *2025*(8), 2025–3912. https://doi.org/10.70838/pemj.400808

Maharani W, & Hongki. (2025). *Analysis of Pedagogical Content Knowledge (Pck) of Undergraduate Students in Making Mathematics Teaching Modules Using the Steam Approach. 11*. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.33654/math.v11i1.11

Mizzi, E. (2022). *Powerful Knowledge and Pedagogy in the Maltese Secondary School Economics Classroom.*https://discovery.ucl.ac.uk/id/eprint/10157064/1/Mizzi_10157064_thesis_revised.pdf.

Moore, N., Coldwell, M., & Perry, E. (2021). *Exploring The Role of Curriculum Materials In Teacher Professional Development. Professional Development in Education*, *47*(2–3), 331–347. https://doi.org/10.1080/19415257.2021.1879230

Nakar S, & Du Plessis A, E. (2023). *Facing The Dilemma f The Out-Of-Field Teaching Phenomenon in Vocational Education and Training (VET). 16*. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1007/s12186-023-09329-8

Obias D, Matitu C, A, Almodovar B, J, Nacu K, F, & Simon C, L. (2025). *Exploring The Influence of Out-Of-Specialized-Field Teaching on Educators Development and Motivation. 6*. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.11594/ijmaber.06.02.26

Ogundairo O. (2024). *Psychological Burden and Coping Mechanisms of Out-Of-Field Teachers: A Phenomenological Study.* https://www.researchgate.net/publication/396623975_psychological_burden_and_coping_mechanisms_of_out-of-field_teachers_a_phenomenological_study

Orakcı, Ş., Yüreğilli Göksu, D., & Karagöz, S. (2023). *A Mixed Methods Study of the Teachers' Self-Efficacy Views and their Ability to Improve Self-Efficacy Beliefs During Teaching. Frontiers in Psychology*, *13*, 1035829. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.1035829

Pacaña N, M. (2019). *Out-Of-Field Social Studies Teaching Through Sustainable Culturebased Pedagogy: A Filipino Perspective. 7*. https://doi.org/10.18488/journal.61.2019.73.230.241

Perez M. (2024). *A Tale of Experience: Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects. 2*(6). https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14493891

Pilar, E. G. D., & Militante, B. T. (2020). *Teaching Non-Major Subjects: Lived Experiences of Deped SHS Teachers. Solid State Technology.*

Pressley, T., & Rangel, R. (2023). *Elementary Teacher Self-Efficacy After a Year of Teaching During COVID-19. Psychology in the Schools, 60*(9), 3284–3297. https://doi.org/10.1002/pits.22921

Rebolledo, J. D., Calimag, R. C., Francisco, R. S., & Arias, S. T. (2025). *Bridging Knowledge Gaps in Out-Of-Field Teaching: A Qualitative Exploration of Teacher Challenges, Instructional Strategies, And Institutional Support. Diversitas Journal*, *10*(2). https://doi.org/10.48017/dj.v10i2.3372

Rebucas, E. (2022). *Experiences Of Science Teachers Teaching Non–Science Subjects: A Phenomenology Study. International Journal on Studies in Education*, *4*(2), 130–140. https://doi.org/10.46328/ijonse.73

Richard, K., & Calorine, A. (2024). *Schemes Of Work nd Teaching in Kisoro District: A Case Study of Savior Secondary School in Nyakinama Sub County* (Vol. 3, Issue 1). https://www.researchgate.net/publication/377771896

Rodriguez, R. D. (2025). *Out-Of-Field Teaching in Rural Senior High Schools: Prevalence, Challenges, Support, and Impact on Job Satisfaction Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal Out-Of-Field Teaching in Rural Senior High Schools: Prevalence, Challenges, Support 35*(1), 25–38. https://doi.org/10.70838/pemj.350104

Roxas Richard. (2022). *Being Out-Of-Field: A Phenomenological Research on the Lives of Teachers Teaching Non-Major. 11*. https://doi.org/10.5861/ijrse.2022.b017

Rutgers, D., Hotham, E., Perry, E., Rempe-Gillen, E., De Winter, J., & Hartley, R. (2025). *Understanding Subject Specific Professional Development for Out-Of-Field Teachers: An Evidence Review.*

Salvador, R., Limon, M., Borromeo, C. M., Parinas, M. A., Manrique, L., Cruz, L. De La, & Dalere, J. M. (2022). *Exploring Technical-Vocational Education Teachers' Challenges and Adaptation Strategies in Teaching Courses Outside their Specializations. Journal Of Technical Education and Training*, *14*(2), 34–48. https://doi.org/10.30880/jtet.2022.14.02.004

Sydnor, J., Davis, T. R., & Daley, S. (2024). *Learning From the Unexpected Journeys of Novice Teachers' Professional Identity Development. Education Sciences 2024, Vol. 14, Page 895*, *14*(8), 895. https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci14080895

Tingzon, L. L., & Jay Buyok, H. A. (N.D.). *European Journal of Education Studies Lived Experiences of Non-TLE Teachers Teaching TLE Subjects: A Phenomenological Inquiry*. https://doi.org/10.46827/ejes.v9i11.4538

Tope, M, A. (2023). *Challenges, Coping Mechanism of Non-Specialized Teachers and Organizational Resiliency of Secondary Schools in The Division of Laguna. Education*, *126*(1), 17–17. https://doi.org/10.47119/ijrp1001261620224989

Villano-Ac A. (2024). *Non-Specialized Teachers Handling Major Subjects* *4*(5). https://doi.org/https://www.ijamsbbp.net/wp-content/uploads/2024/06/5-ijams-may-2024-203-215.pdf

Wheeley, E., Klieve, H., & Plessis, A. Du. (2023). *Preservice Teachers' Perceptions About Out-Of-Field Teaching: Implications for Students, Teachers and Schools. Australian Journal of Teacher Education*, *48*(4).https://doi.org/10.14221/1835-517x.5619

Yumang J. (2021*). Bittersweet Moments in Teaching Non-Specializedsubjects Among Senior High School Teachers. 2*. https://doi.org/https://media.neliti.com/media/publications/383186-none-ea224e83.pdf

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: LEA MAE L. BURDEOS

ADDRESS: P-2, Maningalao Las Nieves Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: leamae_burdeos@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female

Date of birth : January 5, 2006

Height : 5’5

Weight : 49

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Maningalao Elementary School

Secondary : Maningalao National High School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Local Student Government	**BTVTED REPRESENTATIVE**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JOHN PAUL C. CEREZ

ADDRESS: P-7, San Mateo, Mabuhay, Butuan City

EMAIL: johnpaul_cerez@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : October 6, 2004

Height : 5’8

Weight : 75

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : San Mateo Annex Elementary School

Secondary : Tungao National High School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Michaelinian Performing Arts Guild	**Member**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: RICA C. JAYME

ADDRESS: P-14, Poblacion, Sibagat, Agusan del Sur

EMAIL: rica_jayme@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female

Date of birth : March 14, 2001

Height : 5’3

Weight : 60

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Afga Central Elementary School

Secondary : Sibagat National High school of Home Industries

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: PRINCE ROBERT T. MIOLE

ADDRESS: P-8, Barangay 3, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: princerobert_miole@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : October 21, 2005

Height : 5'3

Weight : 62

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Buenavista Elementary School

Secondary : Buenavista Special Education Integrated School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Michaelinian Performing Arts Guild	**Member**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JONATHAN C. RABUYA

ADDRESS: P-4, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: jonathan_rabuya@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : July 04, 2005

Height : 5'11

Weight : 62

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Malapong Elementary School

Secondary : Buenavista National High School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JORDAN JAMES M. VASQUEZ

ADDRESS: P-4, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: jordan_vasquez@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex	: Male
Date of birth	: December 21, 2003
Height	: 5’5
Weight	: 65
Civil Status	: Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary	: Buenavista Elementary School
Secondary	: Saint James High School INC.
Tertiary	: Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDIX A

Letter of Approval with Certificate of Appearance and Photo

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

ARLYN A. PINAT
School Principal III
Buenavista National High School

Dear Ma'am Pinat,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

TO: SIR EDMAR
pa-facilitate !

Approved by:

ARLYN A. PINAT
School Principal III

Date:

Scanned with CamScanner

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

MARIA VENUS L. RALLOS
School Principal I
Buenavista Special Education High School
Brgy.3 Buenavista, Agusan Del Norte

Dear Ma'am Rallos,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

MARIA VENUS L. RALLOS
School Principal I

Date: Oct 17, 2025

Scanned with CamScanner

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

ELENITA S. VERDON, Ph.D.
School Principal IV
Nasipit National Vocational School

Dear Ma'am Verdon,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

ELENITA S. VERDON, Ph.D
School Principal IV

Date: 10/16/2025

Note,
Back on Oct. 21, 2025
@ 1:44 p.m.

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

LYDIE GWEN G. OÑATE-CAR
Head Teacher I
Culit National High School
D-3 Culit, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Oñate-car,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted,
Oct. 30, 2025 1:11 pm

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

Record:
Culit NHS
10/30/25

LYDIE GWEN G. OÑATE-CAR
Head Teacher 1

Date:

Scanned with CamScanner

EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT

October 2025

JOCELYN B. PACON
School Principal IV
Carmen National High School
Cabatuan, Carmen, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Pacon,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE T. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Sir Ryan Approved
Please take charge..

Approved by:

JOCELYN B. PACON
School Principal IV

Date

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

MERLITA J. RABINO, MACDDS
School Principal
Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc.
General Luna St. Poblacion, Carmen, Agusan Del Norte

Dear Ma'am Rabino,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE U. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

MERLITA J. RABINO, MACDDS
School Principal

Date:

Scanned with CamScanner

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October 2025

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
BTVTED-3 Student
SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
leamae_burdeos@smccnasipit.edu.ph
09816166302

BENJIE SIAO III
Author

Subject: Request for Approval of Research Instrument

Dear Sir Siao III,

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In line with this, we would like to respectfully request your approval to use your research instruments for data collection, such as survey questionnaires, interview guides, and others, which we found highly suitable for our study. We intend to use them for gathering data on teachers' experiences and adaptation strategies. We assure you that they will be handled with care and used responsibly.

Your approval and any recommendations you may provide will be highly appreciated to ensure the reliability, validity, and ethical soundness of our data-gathering process. Your support would greatly contribute to the success of our research.

Thank you very much for your time and kind consideration.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Research Leader

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

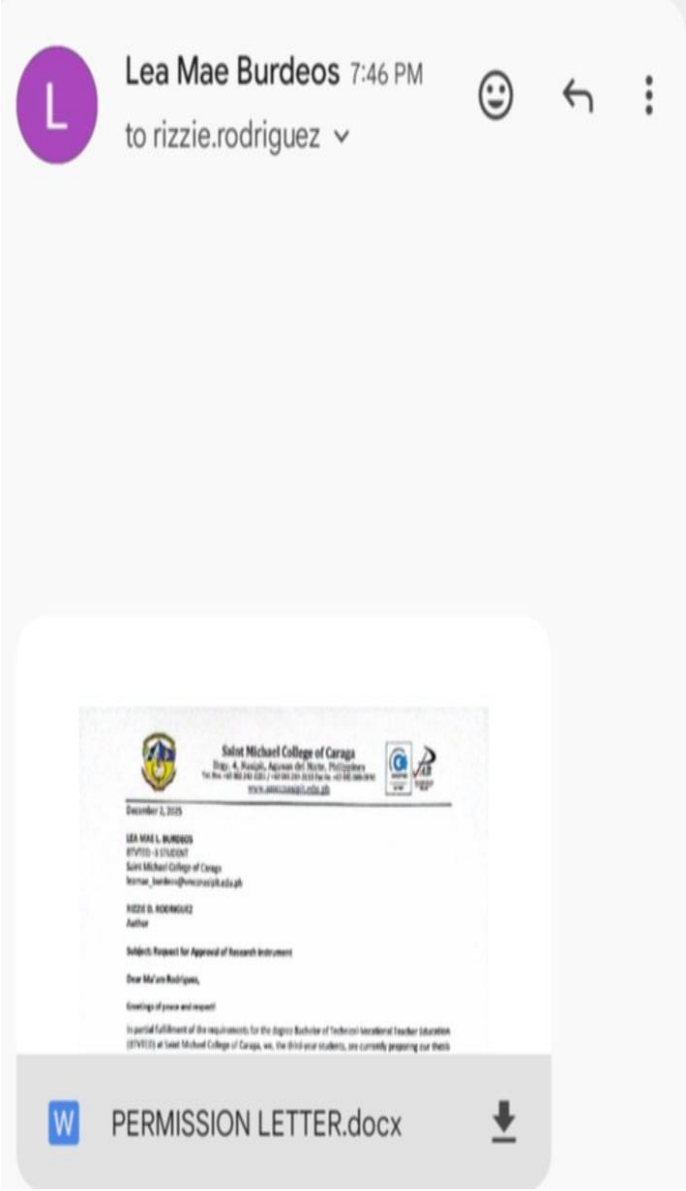
Approved by:

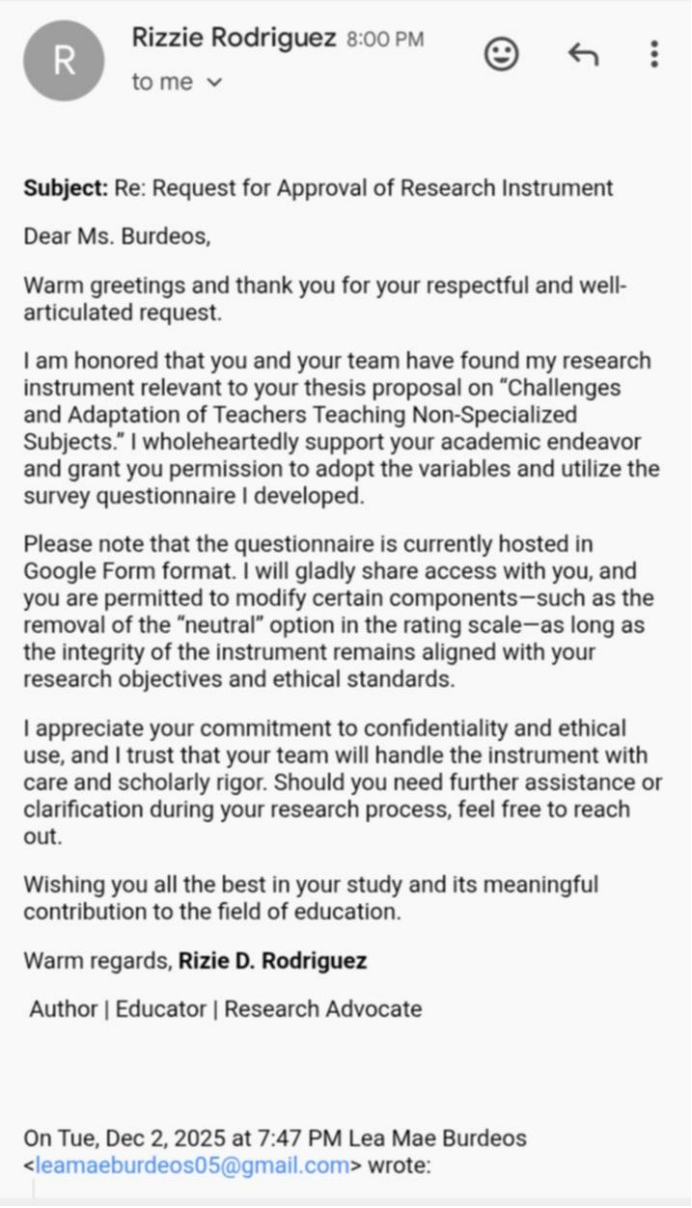
BENJIE SIAO III
Author Date:

Scanned with CamScanner

APPENDIX B

Instrument with Informed Consent





Saint Michael College of Caraga
Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines
Tel. Nos. +63 085 343-3251 / +63 085 283-3113 Fax No. +63 085 808-0892
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

December 2, 2025

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
BTVTED -3 STUDENT
Saint Michael College of Caraga
leamae_burdeos@smccnasipit.edu.ph

RIZZIE D. RODRIGUEZ
Author

Subject: Request for Approval of Research Instrument

Dear Ma'am Rodriguez,

Greetings of peace and respect!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree Bachelor of Technical-Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTED) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing our thesis proposal entitled **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

We respectfully request your permission to adopt the challenges variables used in your study, as well as your research instrument (survey questionnaire), for application in our research. Your instrument aligns strongly with our research objectives and is highly relevant to the core areas we aim to investigate. To enhance the clarity of participant responses, we likewise seek your approval to modify specific components of the instrument, particularly the removal of the "neutral" option in the rating scale, so as to obtain more explicit and meaningful data.

We assure you that your instrument will be handled with the utmost confidentiality, used exclusively for academic purposes, and administered in strict adherence to established ethical standards. Your approval—along with any recommendations or conditions you may wish to provide—will greatly strengthen the reliability, validity, and methodological soundness of our data-gathering process.

We sincerely appreciate your time, support, and kind consideration. Your contribution will play a significant role in ensuring the quality and success of our research.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Research Leader

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

APPENDIX B

Research Survey Questionnaire

"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non- Specialized Subjects"

General Instructions: Please answer each question honestly. Your responses will be kept strictly confidential and used for research purposes only. There are no right or wrong answers.

Part I: Teachers' Profile

Name (Optional): _____

Directions: Put a (✓) check on the box that corresponds to your answer.

A. Sex:

☐ Male

☐ Female

B. Qualification:

☐ Bachelor's Degree

☐ With Master's Units

☐ Master's Degree Holder

☐ With Doctoral Units

☐ Doctoral Degree Holder

☐ Others: _____

C. Years of Teaching:

☐ 1–5 years

☐ 6–10 years

☐ 11–15 years

☐ 16 years and above

☐ Others: _____

D. Area of Specialization:

☐ Science

☐ English

☐ Filipino

☐ Mathematics

☐ Technology and Livelihood Education (TLE)

☐ Physical Education

☐ Araling Panlipunan

☐ Edukasyon sa Pagpapakatao

☐ Others: _____

E. Subjects Handled Out of Specialization:

- ☐ Science
- ☐ English
- ☐ Filipino
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Technology and Livelihood Education (TLE)
- ☐ Physical Education
- ☐ Araling Panlipunan
- ☐ Edukasyon sa Pagpapakatao
- ☐ Others: _____

F. School Location:

- ☐ Buenavista National High School
- ☐ Buenavista Special Education High School
- ☐ Nasipit National Vocational School
- ☐ Culit National High School
- ☐ Carmen National High School
- ☐ Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc.

Part II: CHALLENGES (adapted)

DIRECTIONS: For each section, please indicate how much you agree or disagree with the statement by putting a (✓) check on the box on the right side of each statement. There are no right and wrong answers. Your answer will be kept strictly confidential and you will not be identified.

Likert Scale	Description	Interpretation
1	Strongly Disagree (SD)	The statement does not coincide with my experience.
2	Disagree (D)	The statement slightly coincides with my experience.
3	Agree (A)	The statement moderately coincides with my experience.
4	Stongly Agree (SA)	The statement highly coincides with my experience.

I. Challenges

A. Lack of subject knowledge	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I struggle to explain complex concepts in a way that my students understand.				
2. I spend a significant amount of extra time learning the material immediately before teaching it.				
3. I feel unprepared to answer student questions related to the subject matter.				
4. My lack of subject-specific knowledge negatively impacts my teaching effectiveness.				
5. I am concerned that my students are not receiving a high-quality education due to my lack of expertise.				
6. I experience anxiety and self-doubt when teaching topics outside my area of expertise.				
B. Classroom management	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I struggle to maintain student engagement in subjects outside my area of training.				
2. I find it difficult to adapt my teaching style to effectively manage behavior in unfamiliar subjects.				

3. Students in my out-of-field classes are more likely to exhibit disruptive behavior.				
4. My lack of confidence in the subject makes it harder to address student discipline issues effectively.				
5. I feel less equipped to create engaging and relevant lesson plans, leading to classroom management challenges.				
6. I struggle to build positive relationships with students in subjects where I lack expertise.				
C. Support and Resources	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I feel unsupported by the school administration regarding the specific challenges of teaching non-specialized subjects.				
2. Opportunities for collaboration with experienced teachers in teaching non-specialized subject areas are limited.				
3. Professional development programs fail to address the unique needs of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.				
4. Access to mentorship or guidance from experienced teachers in subjects outside my specialization is insufficient.				
5. The resources provided by the school are inadequate for addressing the unique challenges of teaching non-specialized subjects.				
6. I struggle to find relevant and helpful resources to support my teaching in subjects outside my field.				
D. Psychological Challenges	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. Teaching subjects outside my specialization makes me feel anxious and uncertain.				
2. I often experience stress when preparing lessons for unfamiliar subjects.				
3. I sometimes doubt my teaching abilities when handling out-of-field topics.				

4. Teaching outside my field causes me to feel emotionally exhausted or burned out.				
5. I feel less motivated when assigned to teach subjects beyond my expertise.				
6. My overall job satisfaction decreases due to the challenges of teaching non-specialized subjects.				

PART III: ADAPTATION (researchers- made questionnaire)

A. Learning from seasoned teachers	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I seek advice from experienced teachers when teaching subjects outside my specialization.				
2. I observe veteran teachers' classes to learn effective teaching techniques.				
3. I apply feedback from senior colleagues to improve my teaching performance.				
4. I feel more confident teaching non-specialized subjects after consulting experienced mentors.				
5. I regularly discuss lesson planning and strategies with seasoned teachers.				
6. Guidance from experienced teachers helps me view teaching non-specialized subjects as a learning opportunity.				
B. Learning from textbooks	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I rely on textbooks as my main guide when teaching unfamiliar subjects.				
2. I review textbook lesson sequences to understand the flow of the subject matter.				
3. I use textbook examples and exercises to strengthen my understanding of new content.				

4. Textbooks help me deliver lessons with greater confidence and accuracy.				
5. I find that well-organized textbooks make it easier to teach beyond my specialization.				
6. Using textbooks enhances my subject matter knowledge in out-of-field areas.				
C. Learning from schemes of work	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I follow the school's schemes of work to plan lessons in subjects outside my field.				
2. Reviewing schemes of work helps me understand curriculum expectations.				
3. Collaborating with colleagues on schemes of work improves my lesson organization.				
4. Schemes of work guide me in setting clear lesson objectives and pacing.				
5. I use shared lesson frameworks to align my teaching with school standards.				
6. Schemes of work encourage reflective and team-based lesson planning.				
D. Training and Seminars	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I attend training programs to enhance my teaching competence in unfamiliar subjects.				
2. Seminars and workshops increase my confidence in handling out-of-field topics.				
3. Training sessions expose me to new and effective teaching methodologies.				
4. I actively apply what I learn from seminars to my classroom practice.				
5. Professional training motivates me to improve my teaching skills continuously.				

6. Participating in training programs enhances my professional growth and morale.				
E. Using Technology to navigate	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I use digital platforms to prepare lessons for subjects outside my specialization.				
2. Technology helps me access additional learning materials and resources online.				
3. I incorporate multimedia tools to make lessons more engaging and comprehensible.				
4. Online tutorials and simulations help me understand complex subject topics.				
5. I use educational technology to assess and track students' learning progress.				
6. Integrating technology improves my effectiveness in teaching non-specialized subjects.				

APPENDIX C

Map of the Research Locale

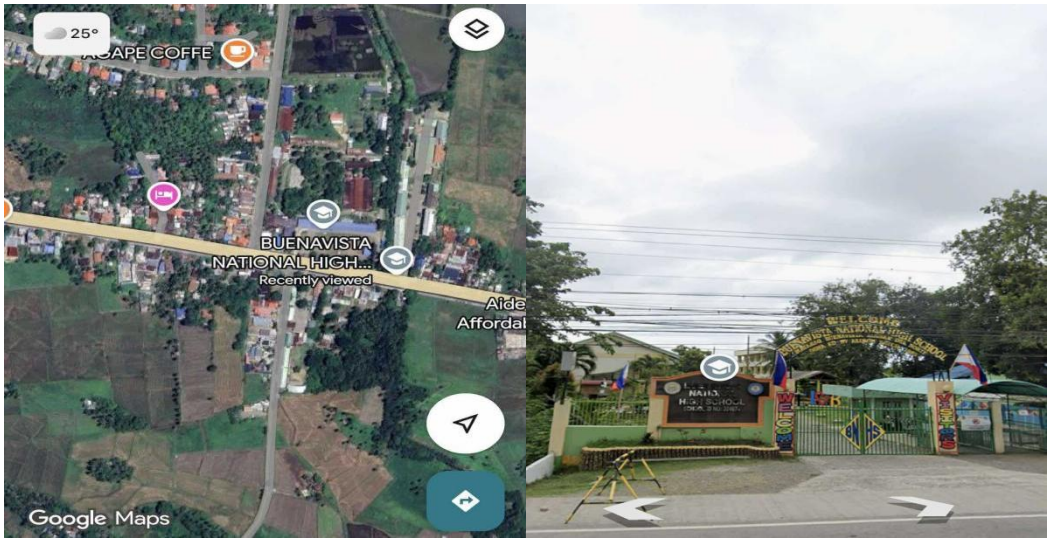


Figure 1: Buenavista National High School

The coordinates for Buenavista National High School are approximately 8.97° North latitude and 125.42° East longitude.

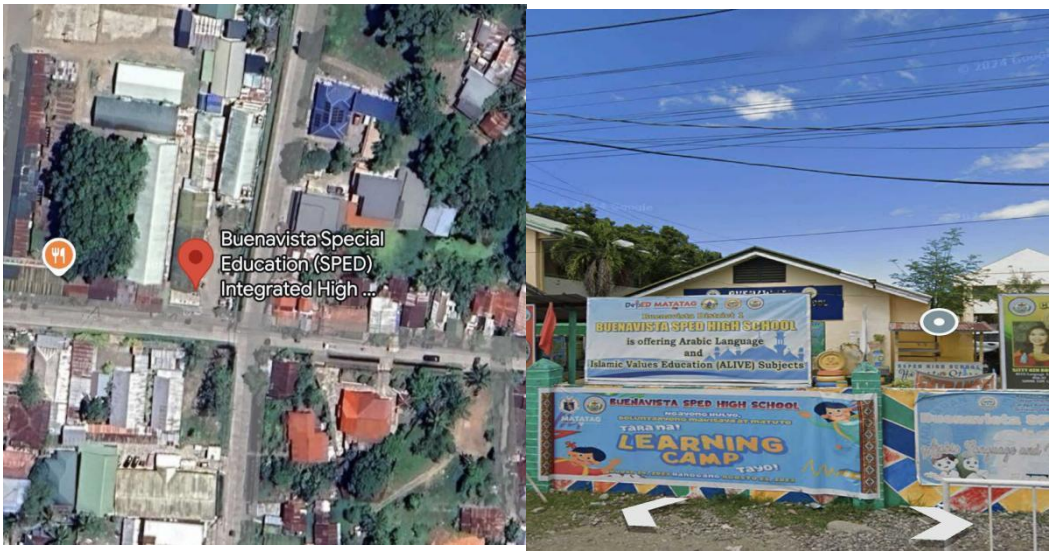


Figure 2 Buenavista Special Education High School

The coordinates for Buenavista Special Education High School are approximately 8.975° North latitude and 125.410° East longitude.

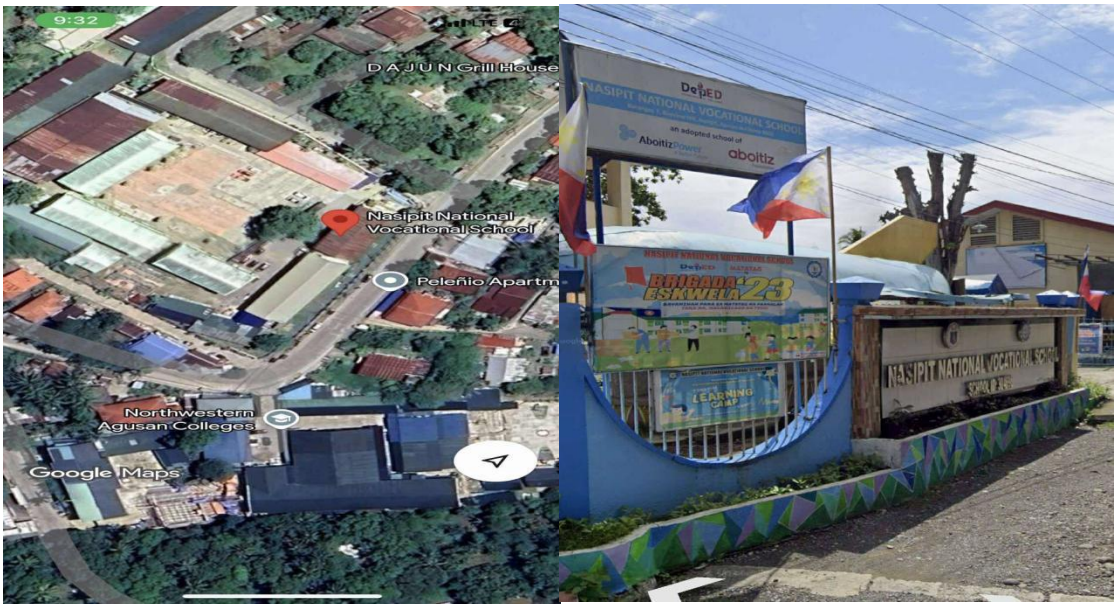


Figure 3 Nasipit National Vocational School

The Nasipit Vocational National High School is located at Bayview Hill, Barangay 7, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines. 8°59’N, 125°20’E (or in decimal format: 8.9884, 125.3408).



Figure 4 Culit National High School

The coordinates for Culit National High School are approximately 8.94° North latitude and 125.36° East longitude.



Figure 5 Carmen National High School

The coordinates for Carmen National High School are approximately 8.4698° N, 124.6319° E.

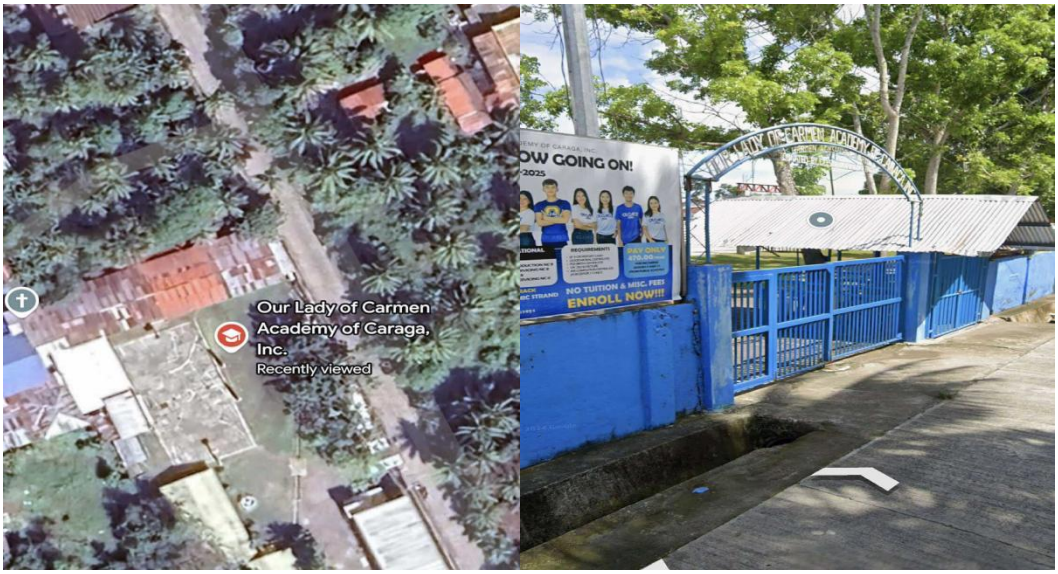


Figure 6 Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc.

The coordinates for Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc. are 8.99° North latitude and 125.29° East longitude.

Narrative & Photo Documentation

- Brainstorming for Research Titles.





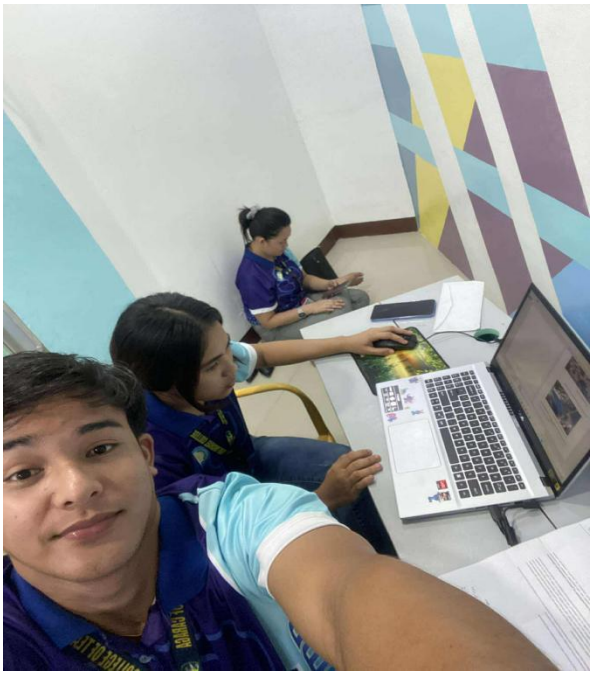




- Making Chapter 1 and 2.









- Visiting school principal to our respective respondents.









- Preparing for Chapter 1 and 2 proposal.







